



MARCH 18th 2026

COMMITTEE OF THE WHOLE MEETING- SESSION B

AGENDA

Date: Wednesday March 18, 2026
Time: 6:00 PM
Location: 108 E. Green Street Ithaca NY 14850
Watch Online: <https://www.youtube.com/@CityofIthacaPublicMeetings>

1. **Call To Order**
 - 1.1. Emergency Evacuation Notice
 - 1.2. Agenda Review
2. **Petitions and Hearings of Persons Before Council**
3. **Approval of Meeting Minutes**
 - 3.1. 02-11-2026 COW-A Meeting Minutes
4. **Special Presentation**
 - 4.1. Bonadio Update
5. **Finance & Administration**
 - 5.1. [Outdoor Dining Permit](#)
 - 5.2. [Towing Policy - Adjustment to Maximum Towing & Storage Rates](#)
 - 5.3. [Water Meter Cap](#)
6. **Public Safety**
 - 6.1. [Tactical Team Grant](#)
7. **Public Works & Operations**
 - 7.1. [How Transportation Projects Get Done- Local vs. State/Federal Funding](#)
 - 7.2. [Hancock Street Bridge over Cascadilla Creek Replacement Project](#)
 - 7.3. [East State Street Rehabilitation Project](#)
 - 7.4. [Spencer Road Improvement Project](#)
8. **Mayor & Council Policy Priorities**
 - 8.1. [City Policy Priorities](#)
9. **Council Liaisons & Working Groups- Reports & Updates**
10. **Reports From City Staff- Review & Discussion**
11. **Meeting Wrap-Up**

Public Comment

The public can provide short statements during this portion of the meeting. 3 minutes is the maximum time allotted, but the chair reserves the right to modify the amount of time per individual at the start of the meeting. Only the first hour of the meeting is set aside for Public Comment. Groups of 3 or more speakers **are allotted more speaking time.**

For Longer Speaking Time - Multiple speakers on the same topic can speak as a group with one Designated Speaker to represent the Group. This will give you more time to share your thoughts and concerns during the Public Comment Forum.

3-4 Persons with One Designated Speaker - Allotted 5 minutes

5 or More Persons with One Designated Speaker - Allotted 7 minutes

Can't Come to the Meeting but still want to speak?

Register to Speak Virtually - [Click Here To Register](#)

Attending the Meeting to Speak in Person? Pre-Registration Not Required

Comment Cards are provided to those who attend in person. Once you have filled out your Comment Card, please hand your card to the Clerk. Your name will be called to speak in the order the cards are received.

Please Note Comment Cards will be accepted up until the Public Comment Forum begins or a maximum of 30 speakers, whichever comes first. Once we have reached a maximum of 30 speakers, you can submit your comment using the Written Comment Link Below.

Want to Submit a Comment and Not Speak in Person?

[Click Here To Submit Written Comments](#)

*Written comments submitted will be compiled and entered into the record.



CITY OF ITHACA

108 East Green Street, Ithaca, New York 14850-6590

Clerk's Office
Shaniqua Lewis, Deputy City Clerk

MEMORANDUM

TO: COMMITTEE OF THE WHOLE MEETING B
FROM: Alan Karasin, City Clerk
DATE: March 18, 2026
RE: Outdoor Dining Permit
ITEM #: 5.1

ATTACHMENTS:
[2026 Outdoor Dining Permit Resolution.pdf](#)

DICE - Approval of Outdoor Dining Alcohol Permits

WHEREAS, several downtown restaurants have requested permission to utilize certain areas along the Primary and Secondary Commons and sidewalks in the downtown core for outdoor dining, and

WHEREAS, the Downtown Ithaca Alliance has requested permission for wine, beer, and hard cider tasting and sales as part of their special events for 2026, and

WHEREAS, it is Common Council's responsibility to determine whether or not to allow the serving and consumption of alcohol on City property, and

WHEREAS, Common Council has determined that the use of public property for outdoor dining and special events including the responsible sale and consumption of alcohol, plays an important role in the vibrancy of the downtown business district, and

WHEREAS, Common Council has determined that any use of this or similar public property involving the sale and consumption of alcohol should be covered by a minimum of \$1,000,000 insurance under the Dram Shop Act; now, therefore be it

RESOLVED, For the year 2026, Common Council hereby approves the following revocable alcoholic beverage permits for the outdoor sale and consumption of alcohol in accord with the terms and conditions set forth in their applications, including minimum Dram Shop coverage in the amount of \$1,000,000 and the approval of an outdoor dining permit:

Food Lab By Luna

Revelry Yards

Simeons

The Lotus

and, be it further

RESOLVED, That the Downtown Ithaca Alliance be authorized to arrange for wine, beer, and hard cider tasting and sale of bottled wine, beer, and hard cider at booths during their special events between the dates of January 1 to December 31, 2026, and shall comply with all applicable state and local laws, and, be it further

RESOLVED, That the Downtown Ithaca Alliance or the participating winery or cider company shall agree to maintain liability insurance in the amount of \$1,000,000.00 and Dram Shop Act coverage in the minimum amount of \$1,000,000.00 naming the City of Ithaca as an additional insured and shall provide evidence of such insurance to the City Clerk prior to the event.



CITY OF ITHACA

108 East Green Street, Ithaca, New York 14850-6590

Public Information and Technology
Christine Ibert,

MEMORANDUM

TO: COMMITTEE OF THE WHOLE MEETING B
FROM: Dept of Information and Community Engagement
DATE: March 18, 2026
RE: Towing Policy - Adjustment to Maximum Towing & Storage Rates
ITEM #: 5.2

Per the City's 2020 agreement with local tow companies, the maximum tow and storage rates are supposed to be reviewed and negotiated every three years. Rates have not been adjusted since the adoption of this policy in March 2020. As such, an updated tow and storage rate proposal is being recommended.

ATTACHMENTS:

[Towing Rates 2026 - Memorandum and Fee Schedule.pdf](#)
[Final Tow policy-City of Ithaca -3-04-2020.pdf](#)



CITY OF ITHACA

108 East Green Street, Ithaca, New York 14850-6590

DEPARTMENT OF INFORMATION &
COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT
Alan Karasin, Director, PIO, City Clerk

Telephone: 607-274-6570
Fax: 607-274-6432
www.cityofithaca.org

To: Common Council
Mayor Cantelmo
Acting City Manager Recckio

From: Alan Karasin, Director
Department of Information & Community Engagement

Date: March 18, 2026

Subj: Towing Fees in the City of Ithaca

Staff are recommending updates to the towing fee structure to simplify the rates and to reflect the fact that towing and storage fees have only been increased once in the past sixteen years, in March 2020. We have been delinquent in revising these rates. Under the existing Tow Policy, rates are required to be renegotiated with tow companies every three years, including in 2023 and again in 2026. Staff met with two of the tow companies and have considered their feedback when making these recommendations. This change aligns with Common Council goals related to Public Works and Operations to “embed equity and accountability into operational practices to ensure consistent, high-quality service and communication across all neighborhoods.”

Chapter 317 of the City Code, “Vehicles, Removal of,” directs the City to follow the Tow Policy. The policy may be administratively updated as needed, which means Common Council is not required to take formal action on the revised fee schedule. Staff is still requesting direction and approval so that the updated rates reflect Council’s oversight and support the City’s broader policy goals.

We are bringing this forward ahead of annual street cleaning. This gives us time to make sure that public-facing materials will clearly show the new rate structure.

Future proposals under review include an annual license application for tow operators. This would help us ensure that companies meet consistent standards, provide reliable customer service to members of the public, and remain accountable to program requirements. It also creates the potential for an annual fee for operating tow services within the City of Ithaca.

City staff typically issues tickets and tows vehicles for the following types of offenses:

- Being Parked in a space marked as No Parking by order of DPW (e.g. street cleaning)
- Parking too close to a fire hydrant or in a fire lane
- Parking in a crosswalk or blocking a driveway
- Parking on private property without permission
- Parking in a truck loading zone (reserved for oversized trucks)
- Parking in a zoned marked “No Parking” (permanent and temporary zones)

“An Equal Opportunity Employee with a commitment to workforce diversification”

Proposed: Maximum Towing and Storage Rates

City of Ithaca Tow Rotation List Maximum Rates

Effective 4/1/2026

Light Duty Tow, 24/7/365, includes winch out and dollies/flatbed/rollback	\$275.00
Winch Out (without tow)	\$100.00 for first 15 minutes, additional \$50 after first 15 minutes. Time must be documented on invoice.
Vehicle Release after Hook-up but before the tow truck moves	\$50.00
Recovery	\$350.00/hour
Extraordinary Removal: requiring the use of Heavy Duty tow trucks or more than one tow truck, a crane, or other extraordinary equipment	Actual costs incurred
Scene/Accident Clean-up and/or Standby Time	Actual costs incurred

Storage Rates

Daily Storage begins 24 hours after vehicle enters yard. Storage release hours are 7:00 am – 7:00 pm daily.	\$50.00/per day after the first 24 hours. Release date must be documented on invoice to be eligible for payment
Emergency after hour releases or release of personal property must be coordinated through the Ithaca Police Department and/or Tow Company . This would occur outside of the storage release hours shown above.	\$100.00 – time and date must be documented on invoice to be eligible for payment

Changes to the comprehensive list of maximum rates will be re-negotiated every three years by the City of Ithaca and the Tow Operators in good standing on the Tow Rotation List. In any year when the comprehensive list is not re-negotiated, the rates for Light Duty Tow, Winch Out after the first 15 minutes, Recovery, and Emergency After Hours Release will increase automatically at 11:59 p.m. on December 31, by 5 percent.

APPENDIX B: Maximum Towing and Storage Rates

City of Ithaca Tow Rotation List Maximum Rates

Light Duty Tow, 24/7/365	\$200.00
Winch Out with tow	\$25.00 if required and documented in police report
Winch Out (without tow)	\$100.00 for first 15 minutes, additional \$35 after first 15 minutes. Time must be documented on invoice.
Dollies/Flatbed/Rollback	\$25.00 if required and documented in police report
Vehicle Release after Hook-up but before the tow truck moves	\$50.00
Recovery	\$325.00/hour
Extraordinary Removal: requiring the use of Heavy Duty tow trucks or more than one tow truck, a crane, or other extraordinary equipment	Actual costs incurred
Scene/Accident Clean-up and/or Standby Time	Actual costs incurred

Storage Rates

Daily Storage begins 24 hours after vehicle enters yard. Storage release hours are 7:00 am – 7:00 pm daily. Emergency after hour releases or release of personal property must be coordinated through the Ithaca Police Department.	\$50.00/per day after the first 24 hours. Release date must be documented on invoice to be eligible for payment \$50.00 – time and date must be documented on invoice to be eligible for payment
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Effective: 03/2020



City of Ithaca

Tow Service Requirements & Policy

Adopted 03-04-2020

1. PURPOSE

The purpose of the establishment and implementation of the City of Ithaca Tow Service Requirements & Policy includes but is not limited to the following:

- A. Providing a non-discriminatory, uniform system for the rotation of tow trucks for Public Works and Public Safety-generated requests.
- B. Effectively serving the needs of the Public Works and Public Safety agencies, the Dispatch Center, the general public, and the towing companies.
- C. Ensuring that tow companies comply with all applicable federal, state, county and city statutes, ordinances and regulations.
- D. Ensuring all impound and storage yards used by tow companies on the rotation tow program comply with the requirements of applicable federal, state, county and city statutes, ordinances and regulations.
- E. Ensuring Public Works and Public Safety agencies receive professional, reliable and capable towing and recovery services.
- F. Assuring the motoring public is provided professional, efficient, reliable towing, handling, storage and recovery services.

2. POLICY

The City of Ithaca Tow Service Requirements & Policy, hereinafter referred to as "policy", does not apply to and is not intended to hinder the activities of any private tow truck business in providing tow services to the general public and/or commercial agreements on a contractual or mutual consent basis. The Tow Service Requirements applies to requests through the Tompkins County Dispatch Center for tow truck services involving the following situations, including but not limited to:

- A. Vehicles involved in accidents requiring the use of tow trucks to remove vehicles
- B. Slide offs requiring the use of tow trucks to pull vehicles back on the roadway
- C. Vehicles that are disabled and require a tow truck to remove
- D. Unlawfully parked vehicles
- E. Abandoned vehicles
- F. Driver Arrest

3. TOWING AREA

- A. This policy shall establish the tow area for light/medium and heavy-duty types of tow trucks to facilitate the distribution of calls and meet the needs of public works and public safety agencies with regards to response time and availability of tow services.
- B. The rotation area is:
 - 1) The City of Ithaca
 - a. Light/medium duty rotation tow truck companies on rotation will respond accordingly
 - b. Heavy duty rotation tow companies operating in Tompkins County shall be dispatched upon request.

4. ROTATION

- A. The Tompkins County 911 Center shall maintain the rotation tow lists for light/medium duty and heavy-duty tow companies.
- B. Tow truck companies shall be dispatched according to their place on the rotation list.
- C. A call to a tow company shall constitute one turn on the list and the tow company shall move to the bottom of the list.
 - 1) This includes when a tow company fails to answer the phone, is unable to respond, is unable to perform the required service, refuses to respond or provide service; or is canceled due to an excessive response time.
 - 2) Any company calling back to cancel or pass more than 25% of its call volume in a one-month period may receive disciplinary action as outlined in the standard suspension rules listed in Section 15.
- D. If it is determined the tow company is not needed and is canceled by Tompkins County, up to and including arrival on scene and standby time which does not result in a tow, the tow company shall be placed back at the top of the rotation list for that tow area.
- E. If the tow company responds to a call and is canceled by the vehicle's registered owner or agent prior to the tow company taking possession of the vehicle, the tow company shall be placed back at the top of the rotation list.
 - 1) Possession is deemed to arise when the vehicle is completely attached to the tow vehicle and immediately ready to go into transit or has been removed and is in transit.
- F. Nothing in this policy shall prohibit a public works or public safety agency from requesting a specific tow company at the request of the vehicle's registered owner or agent.
 - 1) On request of the owner of the vehicle requiring towing, the owner may designate what towing company is to be called. Such a request will not change the order of the tow rotation list. A note will be made on the tow log stating the owner or agent's request.
 - 2) Vehicle owners who belong to AAA or another automobile club and want to use that service will be encouraged to make those calls for service themselves. Should the 911 Center make the call under the direction of the Ithaca Police Department, the call will be placed in the "Requests for AAA/ Auto Club Towing" log.

3) On request of the owner of a vehicle, the vehicle may be towed to any destination designated by the owner. In the event the vehicle is not towed to the storage yard of the towing operator, the owner of the vehicle shall make arrangements for payment of towing and storage fees with the operator of the tow truck and/or owner of the garage or other facility to which the vehicle is to be towed.

- G. If two or more tow companies are called to the same incident scene, distribution of the vehicles shall normally be given by the Dispatch Center; however, it shall be at the discretion of the on scene public safety agency to change assignments if needed. The Dispatch Center shall be notified of any changes. The tow companies shall not change vehicle assignments unless directed by the on scene public safety agency to do so.
- H. A tow company responding to and arriving at a scene, which was not dispatched, shall not tow any vehicle.
 - 1) The public safety agency may use any tow company as a necessary resource to immediately clear a hazard at their discretion. Such expediency clearance of a hazard does not constitute authorization to tow any vehicle from the scene, nor a charge to the owner or agent of the vehicle. If companies on the City of Ithaca Tow Rotation List are not available, the Tompkins County 911 Center is authorized to utilize other tow companies located within and outside of Tompkins County.
- I. A tow company accepting a call under the rotation system must respond to the requested site with the company's own equipment or equipment it has leased.
- J. If another tow company takes the call on behalf of the tow company being dispatched, both companies shall be disciplined following the standard rules listed in Section 15.
- K. Regardless of the class of a tow truck a tow company may send to a call, charges shall not be more than for the class of vehicle towed or serviced.
- L. Tow companies and/or their operators are prohibited from "cruising" or jumping calls by listening to the police band radio or driving the roadways to solicit business in an effort to pre-empt the proper functioning of the rotation system.
 - 1) Tow companies or employees in company vehicles pulling up to any incident scene, such as accidents, slide offs, or break downs/disabled vehicles, that normally would have required law enforcement interaction shall turn on their overheads to warn traffic, determine if there are injuries and notify the Tompkins County Dispatch Center. Once the law enforcement agency arrives, the tow company or employee must leave the scene unless the officer requests their assistance as provided in Paragraph H-1.
 - 2) The tow company may be requested by the officer to move a vehicle to a safe location and leave it. The assistance provided shall not change the tow company's place in the rotation.
 - 3) Any tow truck company cruising or jumping calls will be subject to disciplinary action following the standard suspension rules listed in Section 15.

5. RESPONSE TO CALLS

- A. The tow company shall respond to calls 24-hours a day, seven (7) days a week within the maximum response time limits established by this policy.
- B. An appropriate licensed tow truck driver shall respond with a properly equipped tow truck of the class required to tow the vehicle and be in possession of the appropriate class of license and applicable endorsements.
- C. Response time is the time between notification by the Dispatch Center and time of the arrived at the designated scene. The maximum response times are:
 - 1) Light Duty = 30 minutes
 - 2) Medium / Heavy Duty = 60 minutes
 - 3) Abandoned vehicles not creating a traffic hazard = 24 hours
 - 4) The response time requirements may be extended at the discretion of Tompkins County Dispatch due to circumstances that either hinder compliance or make it impossible to meet; such as inclement weather, blocked roads, or other similar conditions. The tow company is required to notify Dispatch of the reason for delay, ETA and current location.
- D. The tow company shall advise Dispatch, at the time of notification, if they are either unable to respond or unable to meet the maximum response time.
 - 1) If, after accepting the call, the tow company is unable to respond or will be delayed in responding, the tow operator shall immediately notify Dispatch.
- E. If a tow company accepts a call and fails to arrive at the scene within the maximum time limits, except in special circumstances, the call to that tow company may be voided and another tow company called to provide the required services. Disciplinary action shall be in accordance with the standard suspension rules listed in Section 15.
 - 1) Dispatch will log "Unavailable" every time required response times are not met.
- F. A tow company dispatched to the scene of a traffic accident shall be responsible for the cleanup of debris and/or fluids caused by the vehicle involved in the accident from the travel portion of the roadway as required by NYS Vehicle and Traffic Law (VTL) Section 1219, and cleaned to the satisfaction of the public safety agency in charge of the accident. Cleanup shall be completed prior to the tow company leaving the scene. For non-compliance, disciplinary action shall be in accordance with the standard suspension rules listed in Section 15. If a public works or public safety agency performs the clean-up, the towing company forfeits the right to charge for clean-up fees.
- G. A tow company working under this policy as a member offering AAA services will comply with the rules and policies governing accepting AAA service rates and fees unilaterally once sufficient proof of the vehicle owner or agent has proper AAA membership.
 - 1) A separate log will be maintained for owner or agent requests for AAA.
- H. Transportation of customers may be done at the discretion of each tow company.
- I. The City shall share monthly reports on the call out history of the rotation list with all tow operators in good standing on the City's Tow Rotation List.

6. TOW COMPANY APPLICATION / RECERTIFICATION

- A. The non-preference towing rotation list utilized by the City of Ithaca is open to any natural person or legal entity that owns or operates a tow and recovery business within Tompkins County.
- B. For the purpose of application, to be on the towing rotation list within the City of Ithaca, “owns or operates” means having a bona-fide physical yard located within Tompkins County.
- C. Tow companies participating on rotation within the City of Ithaca shall meet all the requirements outlined in this policy and applicable federal, state, county and/or city statutes, ordinances and regulations to remain on the rotation list to include:
 - 1) Comply with all equipment requirements listed in Appendix A.
 - 2) Obtain and display current certification of inspection for each tow truck as required by NYS VTL Article 5 and 5A.
 - 3) Ensure all tow truck drivers are properly trained to operate the equipment they are responding with and properly licensed as required under the NYS VTL Article 19.

7. APPLICATION AND ENROLLMENT

- A. Tow companies wishing to be added to the City of Ithaca rotation program shall contact the City Clerk’s Office and request a tow application packet.
- B. Completed forms shall be returned to the City Clerk or his/her designee.
- C. The tow company shall notify the City Clerk in writing if they wish to be removed from the tow rotation list for a specific time period. Upon receipt, the tow company will be removed from the list and notified. It shall be the tow company’s responsibility to notify the City Clerk in writing when the tow company wishes to return to the tow rotation list. Tow companies returning to the list will be placed at the bottom.
- D. Any tow company failing to meet or maintain all requirements and necessary equipment as set forth by federal, state, county, town, village, or city requirements for truck inspections and certifications or the requirements within this document shall be removed from rotation until such compliance requirements are fixed or corrected. Tow companies shall provide written documentation to the City Clerk’s Office requesting reinstatement to the rotation list.
- E. Initial and periodic Commercial Vehicle Inspections including all tow company equipment, storage yard(s), and all company operations involved in towing and recovery will be conducted by the Ithaca Police Department. Tow companies who fail said inspections will not be allowed to continue with the application process nor be allowed to function off the tow rotation until the failed requirements of the inspection have been corrected as determined by re-inspection.
 - 1) Commercial inspection and re-inspection of a tow company will fall as scheduled with regard to the availability of the Ithaca Police Department.
- F. If a change in address occurs for the principal office of a tow company, the tow company will notify the City Clerk’s Office of this change within five (5) business days.

- G. If a change of ownership or control of the tow company occurs either by sale, transfer, or other legal means, the tow company will notify the City Clerk's Office of this change within five (5) business days.

8. TOW COMPANY REQUIREMENTS

All tow companies participating on the rotation system shall:

- A. Provide a telephone number to the Dispatch Center where the tow company can be reached 24-hours a day and maintain radio or cell phone communications with their tow trucks when responding to rotation calls.
- B. Have a valid Business License for the storage yard issued by the municipality in which the yard is located.
- C. Have current motor vehicle registration(s) issued by the State of New York for all tow trucks responding to rotation calls.
- D. Ensure all drivers/operators have a current and valid driver license in their possession when operating a tow truck on a rotation call.
- E. Maintain and submit proof of the following insurances:
 - 1) Vehicle liability insurance in accordance with the minimum amounts as specified by the City, which such minimum levels shall be updated from time to time and shall be available for review on the City's website and/or in person at the City Clerk's Office. The City of Ithaca shall be named as the Certificate Holder and an Additional Insured on the policy.
 - 2) General premises liability insurance for each storage yard in use in the minimum amount as specified by the City, which such minimum levels shall be updated from time to time and shall be available for review on the City's website and/or in person at the City Clerk's Office. The City of Ithaca shall be named as the Certificate Holder and an Additional Insured on the policy.
 - 3) New York State Workers' Compensation Insurance and New York State Disability Benefits Coverage.
- F. Have their trucks lettered with the company name on the doors of the truck. The name shall match the DOT number issued to the tow truck company. No magnetic, temporary, or removable signs or markings, nor non-lettered trucks will be allowed for rotation calls.
- G. Comply with equipment requirements set forth in Appendix A and upon inspection.
- H. Comply with all applicable motor vehicle laws enacted by the State of New York and exercise diligent and reasonable care when responding to rotation calls.
- I. Comply with directions from public safety agencies, unless such acts would cause unnecessary damage or possible injury to the operator or others in the area.
 - 1) Operators must attempt to resolve these issues on scene prior to initiating the unsafe act using professional interaction with public safety agencies on scene.
 - 2) If the matter cannot be safely and professionally resolved, a public safety supervisor will be directed to the scene to resolve the issue.

- J. Ensure all tow truck drivers are trained to operate the equipment they respond with and are licensed as required under the NYS VTL Title 5, and specifically as addressed in Articles 18, 19 and 20. Training and Certification is required for each driver/operator.
- K. Ensures employees performing tow services on behalf of the tow company are both physically and mentally capable of performing the required duties.
- L. Ensure all operators obtain a copy of their Criminal History and submit it with their tow application. **It is the responsibility of the Tow Company to accept or deny employment based on the operator's criminal history.** Each tow operator must be identified at the time of application to the Tow Rotation List. Each tow operator must undergo a local background check and be free of felonies which will be reviewed on an annual basis. The City Clerk must be notified of any changes to the tow operator list prior to any new operators being utilized in this program, as well as any felony convictions of current tow operators. Unauthorized tow operators may not be on scene of any tows within the City of Ithaca.
- M. Represent a professional image. Employees shall wear clothing that is modest, functional, contributes to safety, and has a driver's name attached.
- N. While involved in the City of Ithaca rotation tow operations or related business, the tow company and/or employee(s) shall refrain from any acts of misconduct including, but not limited to, any of the following:
 - 1) Rude or discourteous behavior to the public, Public Safety units, and competitors
 - 2) Lack of service, selective service, or refusal to provide service which the tow company is capable of performing
 - 3) Any act of sexual harassment or sexual impropriety
 - 4) Unsafe driving practices
 - 5) Exhibiting any objective symptoms or alcohol or drug use
- O. Wear appropriate warning garments (e.g., vests, jackets, shirts, retro reflective clothing) for daylight and hours of darkness in accordance with OSHA Standards and NYS Traffic Incident Management (TIM) Best Practices.
- P. Only respond to a request for service with the equipment and persons necessary to complete the task.
 - 1) Exception would be responding with a driver trainee.

9. TOWING and STORAGE FEES

Vehicle removal and storage charges shall not exceed those listed in Appendix B. All Tow Companies are required to post a copy of the schedule of fees in a conspicuous area on their premises and shall keep a copy of the schedule of fees in all tow trucks to be made available upon demand to the general public.

The towing company shall issue all customers an invoice with detailed charges and may only bill customers for the appropriate equipment and services necessary to complete the assignment. To be reimbursed for storage fees, the invoice must also include the date the vehicle was released. If a vehicle owner or agent requests a vehicle be towed to a specific location, the location must be indicated on the invoice. Any disputes in customer billing received will be

reviewed by the City Clerk, a representative of the involved public works or public safety agencies or their designees, and the towing company.

- A. No more than the maximum towing rates as defined by the City of Ithaca shall be charged. Charges shall not be more than for the class of vehicle towed or serviced.
- B. No more than the maximum storage rates as defined by the City of Ithaca shall be followed.
- C. A towing company who charges rates above those defined by the City of Ithaca, shall be subject to disciplinary action in accordance with the standard suspension rules listed in Section 15.
- D. Tow companies contracted by insurance companies (AAA, Geico, etc.) agree to charge rates established by the insurance company.

10. STORAGE FACILITIES

Tow companies shall operate and maintain a bona fide terminal within Tompkins County where they will store vehicles. The terminal shall be identified by a legible, conspicuously displayed sign. The terminal must be fenced, locked and lighted in a manner to ensure the safety of vehicles stored on the premises. Tow truck operators shall allow for the properly authorized release of motor vehicles in their custody between the hours of 7:00 am – 7:00 pm, seven days a week, 365 days a year. Emergency after hour releases must be coordinated through the Ithaca Police Department. Storage fees may be charged by the tow truck operator after the vehicle has been stored for more than 24 hours. (For example, if a vehicle arrives on Monday at 11:00 am, the storage fee may be charged at 11:00 am on Tuesday and then each additional day at 11:00 am.) An Emergency after-hours service charge may be charged whenever the tow truck operator is called to release a vehicle from the storage yard during the hours of 7:00 p.m. to 7:00 a.m. This after-hours fee must be documented on the invoice along with the date and time of the release of the vehicle. No vehicle impounded by a law enforcement agency shall be liable for all towing and storage fees accrued during the time the vehicle remains unclaimed, or in storage. The costs for towing services rendered are subject to the appropriate state tax. No additional fees, other than the fees that are set forth herein, shall be assessed against the vehicle.

- A. The tow company shall make all reasonable efforts to protect the vehicles and vehicle contents stored on their property. Any incidents of criminal activity including but not limited to vandalism, property damage, and theft shall be reported to the appropriate law enforcement agency.
- B. Storage facilities owned by a towing company and shared with another towing company or another business establishment shall be physically separated and secured from each other.
- C. The tow company employees shall be properly trained to conduct business transactions related to towing, storage and release of vehicles/property. This includes the proper completion of invoices.
- D. Tow company owners will ensure they or their employees are available during normal business hours to aid the public regarding towing issues.

- 1) Unless directed by an appropriate law enforcement agency, a tow company or their employee shall release personal property from a vehicle, in compliance with state law.
 - 2) A receipt shall be provided for the removed property, with a copy placed in the stored vehicle. This procedure shall also apply to the removal of property by the tow company and/or their employee to a secured area within the business.
 - 3) In cases where a vehicle has been impounded for evidence or investigation, personal property will not be released until the vehicle has been cleared by the Law Enforcement agency handling the investigation.
 - 4) No fee shall be charged for the release of personal property during normal business hours.
 - a) An after-hours service charge may be charged whenever the tow truck operator is called to release property/contents from the storage yard during the hours of 7:00 p.m. to 7:00 a.m. This service must be coordinated with the Ithaca Police Department. This fee must be documented on the invoice along with the date and time of the release of property.
- E. Tow companies must comply with NYS VTL Section 184(2) concerning vehicle liens.
- F. Public auctions shall be held pursuant to NYS VTL. The City of Ithaca will conduct public auctions at least twice a year.

11. TOW COMPLAINTS

- A. All related tow service complaints received or initiated by the City of Ithaca against a tow company or tow company's employees, shall be accepted and investigated in a fair and impartial manner.
- 1) All complaints will be received in written form, with all applicable documentation included. Complaints will not be accepted verbally either in person or by telephone.
 - 2) The tow company and their employees shall cooperate with the City of Ithaca during an investigation.
- B. The tow company shall be notified in writing of the findings of the complaint and whether it will be considered as a matter for disciplinary action within 30 days of the conclusion of any complaint.

12. COMPLIANCE WITH LAW

- A. The tow companies and employees shall, always, comply with federal, state, and local laws and ordinances and all applicable court orders.
- B. Any conviction of the tow company, owner, operator, employee or driver involving a stolen or embezzled vehicle, fraud related to the towing business, stolen or embezzled property, a crime of violence, a drug-related offense, felony driving while under the influence or alcohol or drugs, misdemeanor driving while under the influence of alcohol or drugs, or moral turpitude may be cause for suspension or removal of a tow company or employee, or denial of a tow company/employer's application, or termination from the tow rotation list.

13. COMPLIANCE WITH POLICY

- A. The tow company agrees, as a condition of inclusion in the tow rotation program, to comply with the terms and conditions of the policy. Furthermore, the tow company or company's agent agrees that failure to comply with these terms and conditions shall be cause for disciplinary action (e.g., written reprimand, suspension, termination, or denial of an application).
- B. A violation of the equipment requirements related to safety shall be cause for suspension.
 - 1) The suspension shall remain in effect until the suspension period is completed and an inspection of the equipment has been made to verify the tow company is in compliance.
- C. A violation of overcharging or a pattern of overcharging shall be cause for suspension.
 - 1) The suspension shall remain in effect until the suspension period is completed and proof of reimbursement to the aggrieved customer(s) has been provided to the City Clerk.
- D. Allowing an incompetent, unprepared, or untrained tow truck driver to respond to a rotation call shall be cause for disciplinary action of the tow company.
- E. A tow company sending a tow truck driver to a rotation call (e.g., those drivers dispatched by the tow company's business) for whom the following information has not been submitted, shall be cause for disciplinary action of the tow company:
 - 1) Tow Operator/Driver Information
 - a. Company owners are responsible and will be held accountable to ensure the proper training of all operators including scene safety training.

14. DISCIPLINARY ACTION

- A. The City of Ithaca shall take disciplinary action against a tow company for violations investigated and sustained. Furthermore, the tow company agrees that failure by the tow company to comply with these terms and conditions shall be cause for disciplinary action (e.g., written reprimand, suspension, denial of an application, or termination from the Tow Rotation List).
 - 1) The City of Ithaca shall retain discretion regarding the length of any suspension imposed pursuant to the terms and conditions of this policy.
- B. Nothing shall preclude the City of Ithaca from taking the appropriate enforcement or administrative action for any violations of the law.
- C. Nothing herein shall be deemed to prohibit the City of Ithaca from immediately suspending, terminating, or denying an application of any tow company or employee whose conduct, in the opinion of the City, is deemed to be a danger to the motoring public, or who has engaged in conduct constituting a flagrant violation.
- D. Records of violations shall be retained by the City of Ithaca for 36 months.

15. TERMS OF DISCIPLINARY ACTION

- A. Violations of the terms and conditions of the policy may be cause for disciplinary action in the following manner:

- 1) First violation within a 12-month period = letter of written reprimand
- 2) Second violation within a 12-month period = 1 to 30-day suspension
- 3) Third violation within a 12-month period = 60 to 90-day suspension
- 4) Fourth violation within a 12-month period = termination from the Tow Rotation Program for a determined period of time

NOTE: In lieu of termination, the City of Ithaca may impose additional suspensions for longer periods, if deemed appropriate.

- B. Violations of the terms and conditions of the policy which warrant suspension for the first violation are categorized as major violations. Any subsequent or continuing major violation may be cause for termination.
 - 1) When considering disciplinary action for a major violation of the policy, the City of Ithaca will take into consideration all violations which have occurred within 36-months prior to the date of the current violation.
- C. A suspended or terminated tow company shall not be eligible for a rotation listing for the duration of the suspension or termination.
- D. If the tow company is serving a suspension for one year or more, the tow company shall be required to have complied with all terms and conditions of the current policy at the time of reinstatement.
- E. A tow company shall comply with all the terms of the suspension prior to reinstatement or re-application.

16. APPEAL HEARING

- A. An Appeal Hearing shall be granted, upon a tow company's request, within ten business days, for any of the following circumstances:
 - 1) The tow company is served with a disciplinary action
 - 2) Denial of a tow company's tow application or a tow company/driver application
- B. A hearing shall be held as soon as practicable.
- C. The hearing shall be conducted by representatives from the Ithaca Police Department, the City Clerk or his/her designee, and a tow operator from another tow company on the City's Rotation List (this position will be rotational). The tow company requesting the hearing shall be entitled to present all relevant facts and circumstances in support of the tow company's position.
- D. The tow company shall be notified in writing of the decision(s) of the Appeals Board within ten business days of the date of completion of the hearing.
- E. Disciplinary action shall not take effect until the appeals hearing process has been exhausted, except for tow companies whose conduct is deemed to be a danger to the motoring public or who continue to violate the terms and conditions of the policy.
- F. If a tow company fails to request a hearing or appeal within the specified time or fails to appear at a scheduled hearing or appeal, the action taken by the City of Ithaca shall be final and the disciplinary action shall take effect upon written notification to the tow company.

- G. A notice of the final disciplinary action will be shared with each tow company on the Rotation List.

17. ANNUAL MEETINGS AND RATE NEGOTIATIONS

The City of Ithaca representatives and the Tow Operators in good standing on the City's Tow Rotation List will meet annually to discuss operations and any issues related to the Tow Service Requirements and Policy. Changes to the Tow Rates and Storage Fees will be negotiated every three years by the City of Ithaca and the Tow Operators in good standing on the Tow Rotation List.

APPENDIX A – Equipment Requirements for Rotation Tow Trucks

Broom
Communication device
Rotor or Amber Light
Shovel
Reflective Traffic Vest
Steering Wheel Locking Device
Fire Extinguisher
Safety Flares
Triangles
Materials and containers for clean-up
Tire Iron
Flashlight
Six (6) Fuses
Sledge Hammer
First Aid Kit
Slim Jim
Bungee Cords
Fire Extinguisher
Safety Shoes
Work Gloves
Two (2) Scotch Blocks
Two (2) Snatch Blocks
Assortment of Hooks and Allow Chains
Recovery Straps
Adequate Battery Boost System
Gas Can
Small Hand Tools
Set of Dollies
Wood Wedges
Air Tank
Pry Bar
Penetrating Oil

Heavy Duty wreckers should have additional equipment such as a 20-ton bottle jack, boom crank, single and double air hoses, set of reflectors, and other tools necessary to deal with larger vehicles.

APPENDIX B: Maximum Towing and Storage Rates

City of Ithaca Tow Rotation List Maximum Rates

Light Duty Tow, 24/7/365	\$200.00
Winch Out with tow	\$25.00 if required and documented in police report
Winch Out (without tow)	\$100.00 for first 15 minutes, additional \$35 after first 15 minutes. Time must be documented on invoice.
Dollies/Flatbed/Rollback	\$25.00 if required and documented in police report
Vehicle Release after Hook-up but before the tow truck moves	\$50.00
Recovery	\$325.00/hour
Extraordinary Removal: requiring the use of Heavy Duty tow trucks or more than one tow truck, a crane, or other extraordinary equipment	Actual costs incurred
Scene/Accident Clean-up and/or Standby Time	Actual costs incurred

Storage Rates

Daily Storage begins 24 hours after vehicle enters yard. Storage release hours are 7:00 am – 7:00 pm daily. Emergency after hour releases or release of personal property must be coordinated through the Ithaca Police Department.	\$50.00/per day after the first 24 hours. Release date must be documented on invoice to be eligible for payment \$50.00 – time and date must be documented on invoice to be eligible for payment
---	--

TOW VEHICLE INSURANCE REQUIREMENTS

Vehicle liability insurance:

For Light Duty Trucks:

Auto liability coverage in the amount of \$1,000,000

On Hook coverage in the amount of \$50,000

Required provisions:

City of Ithaca shall be named as Additional Insured

Waiver of Subrogation in favor of the City of Ithaca shall apply

General commercial/premises liability insurance:

For each storage yard:

Coverage in the amount of \$1,000,000

Required provisions:

City of Ithaca shall be named as Additional Insured

Waiver of Subrogation in favor of the City of Ithaca shall apply

Workers' Compensation and Employers' Liability.

Statutory coverage complying with New York Workers' Compensation Law Section 57 General Municipal Law Section 125, Contractor must submit one of the following:

--CE-200 - Certificate of Attestation of Exemption from NYS Workers' Compensation available at www.web.state.ny.us, OR

--C-105.2 - Certification of NYS Workers' Compensation Insurance, OR

--U-26.3 - State Insurance Fund version), OR

--SI-12 - Certificate of NYS Workers' Compensation Self Insurance, OR

--GSI-105.2 - Certificate of NYS Workers' Compensation Group Self-Insurance

Disability Benefits Requirements.

Statutory coverage complying with NYS Workers' Compensation Law Section 220 (8) under General Municipal Law Section 125, Contractor must submit one of the following:

--CE-200 - Certificate of Attestation of Exemption from NYS Disability Benefits Coverage available at www.web.state.ny.us, OR

--DB120.1 - Certification of Disability Benefits Insurance, OR

--DB155 - Certificate of Disability Self-Insurance

Note: Proof of NYS Workers' Compensation and NYS Disability benefits must be provided on NYS forms listed above (complete information available at www.wcb.state.ny.us or Bureau of Compliance at (866) 546-9322.

Certificates of Insurance needs to be provided every year when policies renew and shall include copies of the Additional Insured and Waiver of Subrogation endorsements

AFFIRMATION AND ACKNOWLEDGEMENT:

This Tow Policy contains terms and conditions a towing company agrees to comply with to receive and maintain a position on the City of Ithaca Tow Rotation List. Any tow company, by agreeing to participate in the program, does not establish a contractual relationship and is not acting as an agent for the City of Ithaca when performing services under the Tow Policy. Exceptions to compliance with the Tow Policy shall not be authorized by a verbal agreement. Any exceptions shall be documented as a written amendment or addendum to the Tow Policy.

Towing Rotation List Applications will not be accepted until they are complete and include all required documentation including but not limited to, vehicle registrations, insurance policies, licensing information, and equipment listings. The application shall be submitted to the Ithaca City Clerk's Office, 108 E. Green Street, Ithaca NY 14850, where it will be kept on file. Any failure to provide valid, up-to-date documentation as referenced in this policy may result in a suspension or removal from the City of Ithaca Tow Rotation List.

I, _____,
(Tow Company Owner Name)

the registered owner of _____
(Tow Company Name)

located at _____
(Physical Company Business Address)

affirm my request to have my tow company included on the City of Ithaca Tow Rotation List and that my company will maintain full compliance with the requirements, standards, and practices listed in the City of Ithaca Tow Policy. I, and my employees will comply with all local, State, and Federal laws, with special attention given to New York Codes of Rules and Regulations (NYCRR) and the New York State Vehicle and Traffic Law (NYS VTL) involving the operation of a wrecker or recovery vehicle on public highways.

Signature Date

Sworn before me this _____ day of _____, 20____

Notary Public



CITY OF ITHACA

108 East Green Street, Ithaca, New York 14850-6590

Water and Sewer
Christine Ibert,

MEMORANDUM

TO: COMMITTEE OF THE WHOLE MEETING B
FROM: Scott Gibson
DATE: March 18, 2026
RE: Water Meter Cap
ITEM #: 5.3

Increasing commercial cap to \$10k, continuing until project is done, and potentially increasing cap for residential to \$1,500

ATTACHMENTS:

[Resolution to Renew the Program to Limit Underpayments of Water Bills due to Meter Replacements.docx](#)

Resolution to Renew the Program to Limit Underpayments of Water Bills due to Meter Replacements

WHEREAS, the Department of Public Works is in its third year of a project to replace approximately 5500 water meters in the City of Ithaca as the current meters and remote reading transmitters are reaching or have already reached the end of their useful life, and

WHEREAS, when the remote reading transmitter fails, water bills are based on estimated readings from historical averages until the meter is replaced, and

WHEREAS, with each replacement, a final meter reading is physically taken from the old meter, and differences between the final meter reading and the account record are normally found, indicating an overpayment, or an underpayment by the customer, and

WHEREAS, most reading differences are minor and accounts can be balanced by minor adjustments in future water bills, and

WHEREAS, some reading differences can be large due to a combination of multiple billing cycles of estimated meter readings, and undetected water leaks that continued to go unnoticed for a lengthy time period, and

WHEREAS, in its May 1, 2024 meeting, Common Council voted to cap the underpayment limit to its customers at \$1,000 from a time period of January 1, 2021 through December 31, 2025 regardless of whether the user was a commercial or residential customer, and

WHEREAS, in as much as the meter replacement program is not yet complete, the cap has now expired and customers have no underpayment relief as of December 31, 2025, and

WHEREAS, commercial water users consume a proportionally larger amount of water than residential making the cap inequitable where it is desirable to require commercial users to have their own separate underpayment cap, now therefore be it

RESOLVED, that the City will extend its underpayment cap program from January 1, 2026 until the City's meter replacement program is complete, and be it further

RESOLVED, that the City has reviewed its underpayment data from the meters replaced since January 1, 2021, and believes that a maximum limit of \$1,500 be set for residential underpayments due to meter reading differences, and \$10,000 be set for commercial underpayments due to meter reading differences, and be it further

RESOLVED, that an underpayment limit of \$1,500 applies only once per metered service replaced between January 1, 2021 and the end of the City meter replacement project for residential users, and be it further

RESOLVED, that an underpayment limit of \$10,000 will apply only once per metered service replaced between January 1, 2021 and the end of the City meter replacement project for commercial users, and be it further

RESOLVED, that the City of Ithaca will collect underpayments up to the limit(s) set herein, through a lump sum adjustment to the following quarterly water bill, with a 2-year payment plan option available upon request to the City Chamberlain.



CITY OF ITHACA

108 East Green Street, Ithaca, New York 14850-6590

Police Department
Christine Ibert,

MEMORANDUM

TO: COMMITTEE OF THE WHOLE MEETING B

FROM: IPD CHIEF TOM KELLY

DATE: March 18, 2026

RE: Tactical Team Grant

ITEM #: 6.1

The City of Ithaca was awarded \$75,000 in federal funding under the FY2022 Tactical Team Grant Program. Funding for this initiative is provided by the U.S. Department of Homeland Security's (DHS) State Homeland Security Grant Program (SHSP) and is administered by the New York State Division of Homeland Security and Emergency Services (DHSES). The performance period for this award is August 1, 2025, through August 31, 2026.

ATTACHMENTS:

[IPD_Grant_Memo.pdf](#)

[Approval of Ithaca City Police Department Enforcement Technology \(LETECH\) Program.pdf](#)

[TT22-1014-E00-AttachmentID-136124-City of Ith_Thomas Kelly.pdf](#)



MEMORANDUM

Date: February 3, 2026

To: Common Council

From: Chief Thomas J. Kelly

RE: Acceptance of E-Grants - (TT22-1014-E00 ,C160417 ,FY2022 Tactical Team Targeted Grant)

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

PROJECT HISTORY, BACKGROUND, & ANALYSIS

On August 1, 2025, the City of Ithaca was awarded \$75,000 in federal funding under the FY2022 Tactical Team Grant Program. Funding for this initiative is provided by the U.S. Department of Homeland Security's (DHS) State Homeland Security Grant Program (SHSP) and is administered by the New York State Division of Homeland Security and Emergency Services (DHSES). The performance period for this award is August 1, 2025, through August 31, 2026.

This funding is provided to improve and develop tactical team capabilities through equipment, training, exercise, and planning projects that support sustainment of the New York State Division of Criminal Justice Services (DCJS) SWAT Team Standards.

KEY ISSUES IDENTIFIED

Several issues were identified to meet the accreditation standards set by DCJS.

The grant total is \$75,000. There is \$10,000 budgeted to backfill OT/pay for training of SWAT Operators. The remaining \$65,000 is broken as follows:

3 helmet mounted night vision binoculars - \$22,500

16 ballistic helmets w/ communications - \$27,500

2 ballistic shields - \$6,000

2 small unmanned aerial systems to deescalate high risk encounters (interior use only) - \$9,000.

QUESTIONS FOR COUNCIL

IPD is requesting the Council accept the award of a \$75,000 technology grant from New York State.

BUDGET IMPLICATIONS & FUNDING

If this grant is not accepted, there will be future expenses that will need to be worked into the budget.

PUBLIC FEEDBACK

N/A



CITY OF ITHACA | WORK SESSION MEMO

NEXT STEPS

N/A

(**xx**) Consent Agenda

(**xx**) IPD – Approval of Ithaca City Police Department Enforcement Technology (LETECH) Program

WHEREAS, The Ithaca Police Department (IPD) was notified that they will receive a \$75,000 tactical team grant, and

WHEREAS, the IPD has recommended the funds be used \$10,000 budgeted to backfill OT/pay for training of SRT Operators. The remaining \$65,000 is broken up as follows:

3 helmet mounted night vision binoculars - \$22,500

16 ballistic helmets w/ communications - \$27,500

2 ballistic shields - \$6,000

2 small unmanned aerial systems for interior use only - \$9,000.; **Now Therefore**, be it

RESOLVED, that the Common Council hereby accepts the \$75,000 Tactical team grant administered by the New York State Division of Homeland Security and Emergency Services (DHSES), and it further

RESOLVED, that the Common Council thanks to the New York State Division of Homeland Security and Emergency Services (DHSES) for the Law Enforcement Tactical Team Grant for 2025- 2026 Budget to the City Police Department, and be it further,

RESOLVED, that the Common Council hereby amends the 2025 Authorized Police Department Budget as follows:

Increase Revenue Account (A3120-3389)	\$75,000
Increase Appropriation Account (A3120-5477-5001)	\$75,000



Homeland Security and Emergency Services

KATHY HOCHUL
Governor

JACKIE BRAY
Commissioner

August 1, 2025

The Honorable Robert Cantelmo
Mayor, City of Ithaca
108 E. Green Street
Ithaca, NY 14850

Dear Mayor Cantelmo:

I am pleased to announce that the City of Ithaca has been awarded \$75,000 in federal funding under the FY2022 Tactical Team Grant Program. Funding for this initiative is provided by the U.S. Department of Homeland Security's (DHS) State Homeland Security Grant Program (SHSP) and is administered by the New York State Division of Homeland Security and Emergency Services (DHSES). The performance period for this award is August 1, 2025, through August 31, 2026.

As outlined in your application, this funding is provided to improve and develop tactical team capabilities through equipment, training, exercise, and planning projects that support counter terrorism missions in your jurisdiction as well as your team's sustainment of the New York State Division of Criminal Justice Services (DCJS) SWAT Team Standards.

Additionally, all capabilities developed through federal FY2022 SHSP funding are required to be deployable regionally and nationally per the federal guidelines. All funding through this grant program is subject to both New York State and federal guidelines and regulations. Finally, all training that is funded through this grant program must be submitted to DHSES within six (6) months of the date of this letter for review and approval.

In order to ensure these funds are made available as quickly as possible, a representative from the Grants Program Administration Unit of DHSES will be reaching out to your grant point of contact. If you have any questions about this program, please contact Eric Abramson, Director of Grants Program Administration at (518) 242-5108.

Congratulations on your award and I look forward to working with you to administer this program.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink that reads "Jacqueline Bray".

Jackie Bray
Commissioner



CITY OF ITHACA

108 East Green Street, Ithaca, New York 14850-6590

Dept of Public Works-Engineering
Christine Ibert,

MEMORANDUM

TO: COMMITTEE OF THE WHOLE MEETING B
FROM: John Licitra
DATE: March 18, 2026
RE: How Transportation Projects Get Done- *Local vs. State/Federal Funding*
ITEM #: 7.1

a 10 min or less presentation highlighting local vs. Fed/State funded projects with 2 examples of completed jobs.

ATTACHMENTS:
[power point JL.pdf](#)



How Transportation Projects get Completed:

(not including grants)



Johnathan Licitra
Civil Engineer / Bridge Manager
jlicitra@cityofithaca.org



2 Types of Projects

- Local Projects:

- NYS DOT CHIPS (Consolidated Local Street and Highway Improvement Program)
- Local funds
- Typical projects < \$1.0 M
- Example Projects from 2025 Construction Season
 - 100 Fayette St Repaving (Individual blocks replaced by City forces or contract)
 - Sidewalk Replacement of 400 Linn St (local funds via Sidewalk Improvement District and work done by contract)



Pics. from 2025 construction; 2023 construction

- Regionally Approved Projects:

- Federal pass thru funds
- NYS DOT funds (i.e. Marchiselli)
- Local funds
- Typical projects > \$1.0 M
- Example Projects from past few years:
 - E. State St. Mill & Repave from E. Green St. to Mitchell St.
 - S. Albany St. Bridge over Six Mile Creek

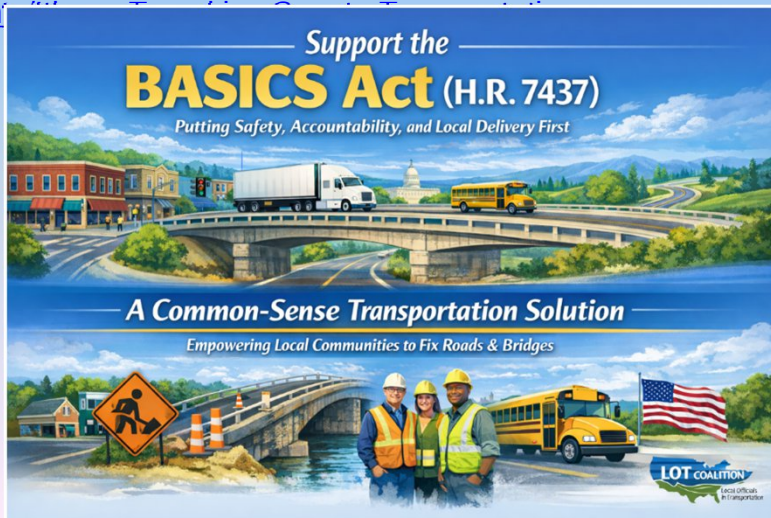


Regionally Approved Projects:

ITCTC:

The Ithaca-Tompkins County Transportation Council (ITCTC) is the Metropolitan Planning Organization (MPO) for Tompkins County. The ITCTC is charged with facilitating county-wide transportation planning.

<https://www.tompkinscountyny.gov/All-Departments/Council>



TIP: Transportation Improvement Program

The Transportation Improvement Program (TIP) is the agreed-upon five-year list of specific projects for which federal funds are anticipated. Required by federal law, the TIP represents the transportation improvement priorities of the Tompkins County Transportation Area. The list of projects is multi-modal and includes highway and public transit projects, as well as bicycle, pedestrian, and freight-related projects.

Image from [Support the BASICS Act \(H.R. 7437\)](#)

3

Regionally Approved Projects:

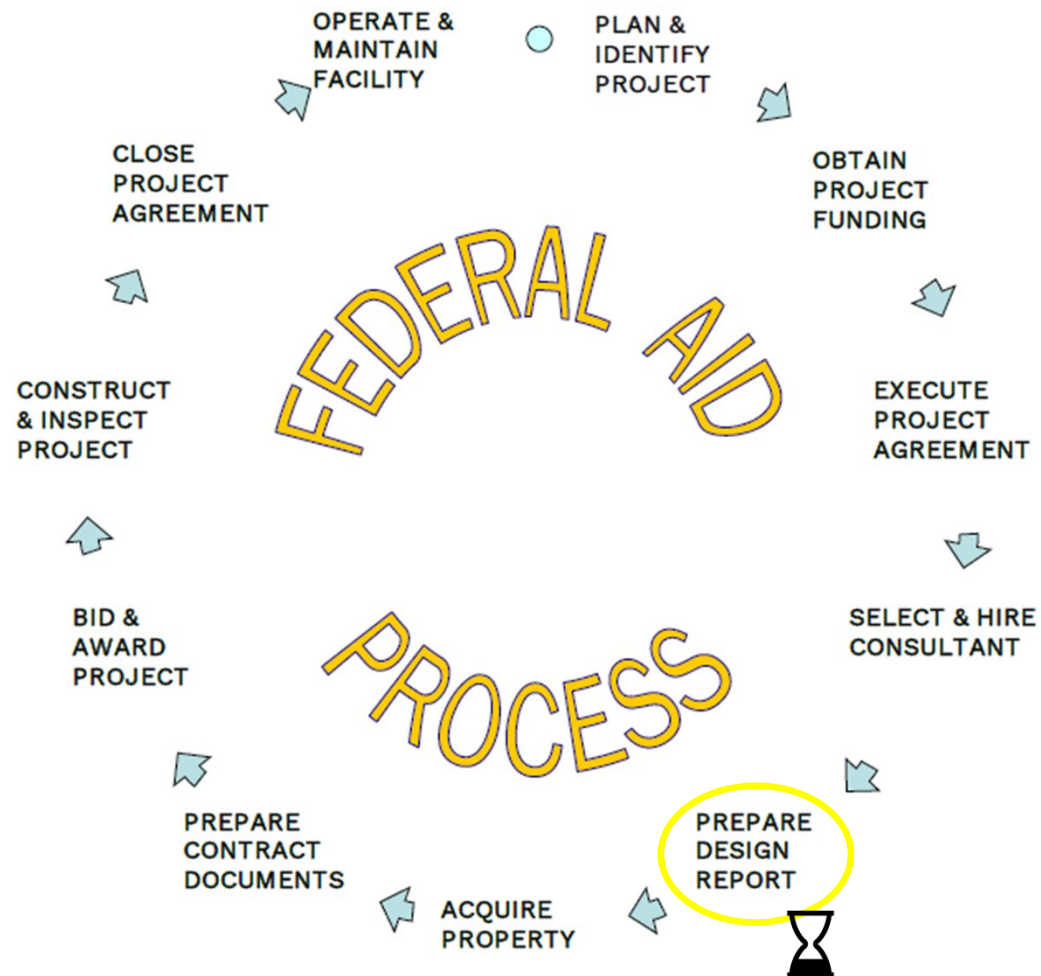
- TIP Highlights:
 - Most projects are 80% Federal & State Funded and 20% Local funded
 - Some projects are 95% or 100% Federal & State funded
 - Marchiselli is at the discretion of the State as to whether a sponsor receives it as a reimbursement (most do).



Pics. from 2020, 2024
Ribbon Cutting
Ceremony

4

Federal-Aid Highway "Reimbursement" Process NYSDOT Local Program Bureau



NYSDOT Main Office Local Programs Bureau

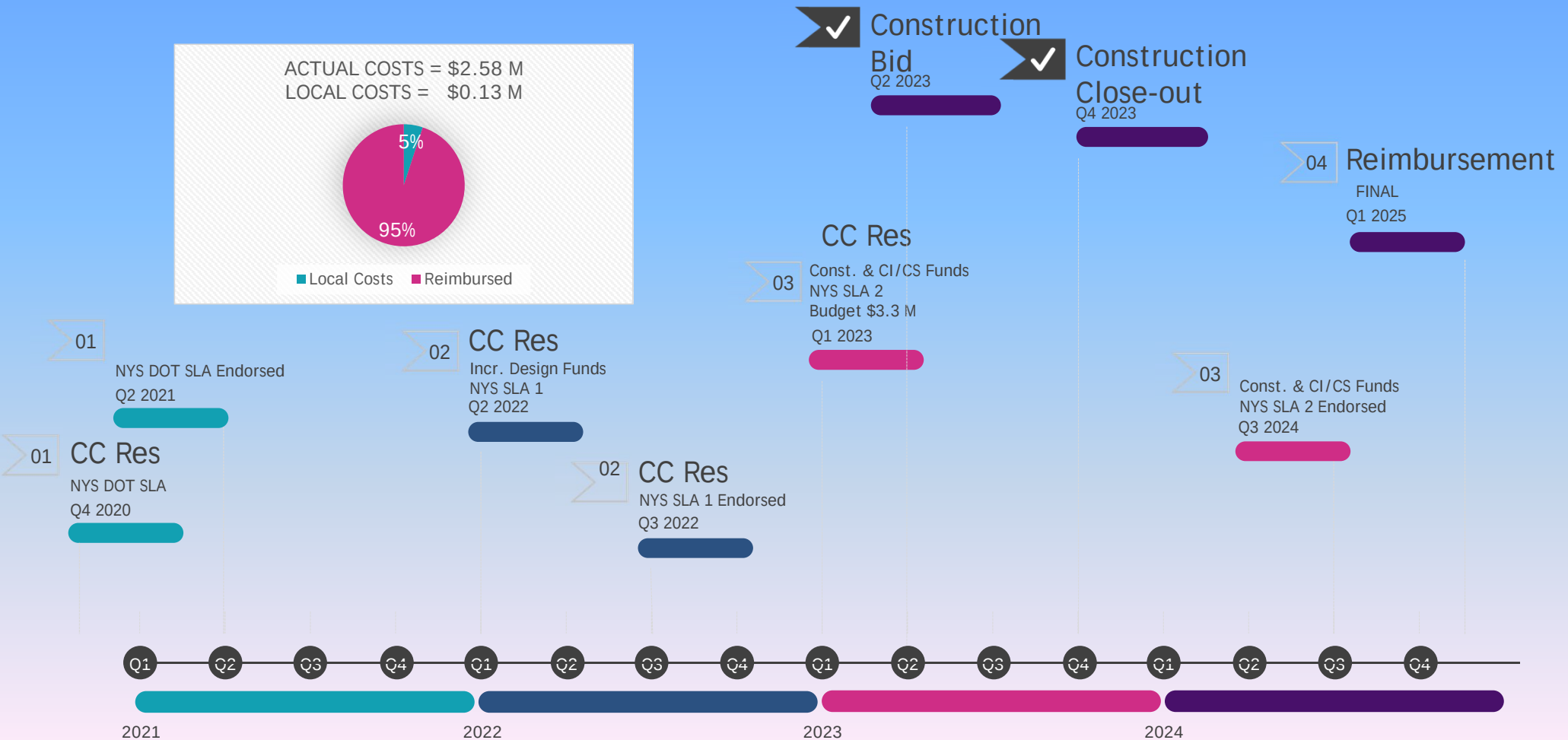
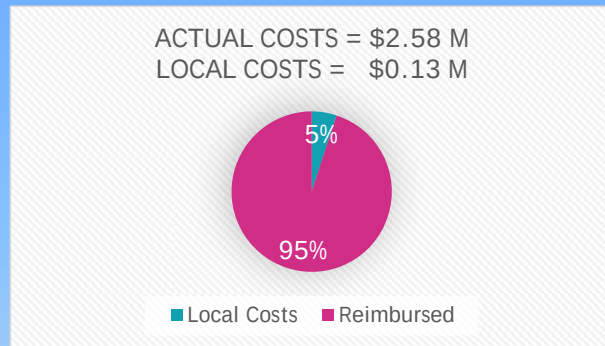
2023-2027 TIP Plan

TIP date 2017 **PIN** 375620 **BIN**
Project Name State St. Mill and Repave from East Green St./Seneca Way to Michell St.
Sponsor City of Ithaca
Description Mill and repave (2R) State St. from East Green St./Seneca Way to Michell St. Replace non-ADA compliant curb ramps and sidewalk. City of Ithaca. Tompkins CO.

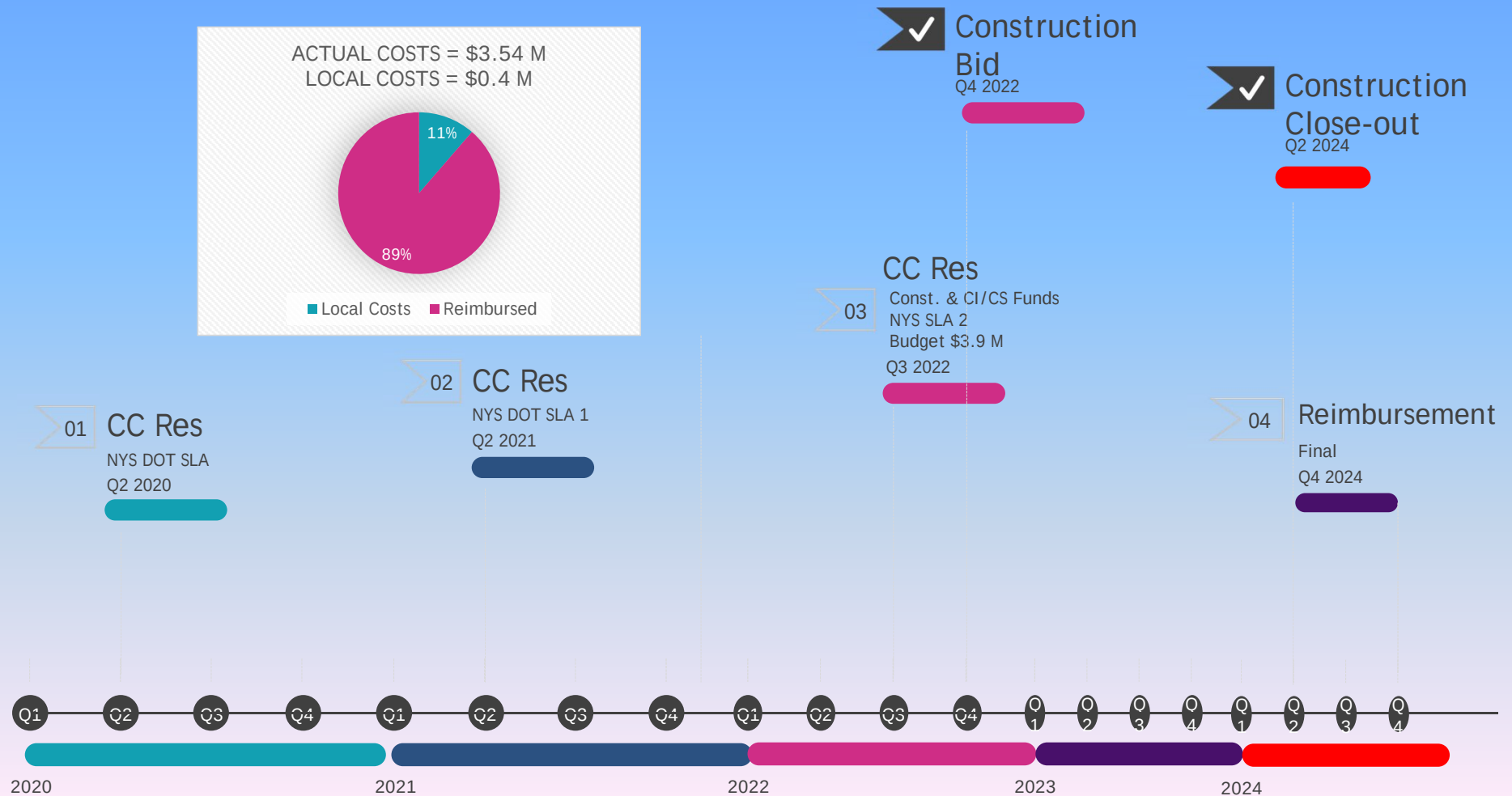
Fund Source: NHPP/STBG-FLEX

Project Element	Funding	Date	Obligated	Date	22/23	23/24	24/25	25/26	26/27	5 YR Total
A-1-Scoping	NHPP	10-20	\$75,000		\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0
B-4-Preliminary Design	NHPP	10-20	\$75,000		\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0
C-7-Detailed Design	NHPP	10-20	\$150,000		\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0
C-8-Detailed Design_2	NHPP	01-22	\$100,000		\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0
G-18-Construction	NHPP		\$0	10-22	\$1,574,000	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$1,574,000
G-19-Construction_2	STBG-FLEX		\$0	10-22	\$656,000	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$656,000
G-20-Construction_3	LOCAL		\$0	01-23	\$341,100	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$341,100
H-22-Inspection	NHPP		\$0	10-22	\$177,000	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$177,000
H-23-Inspection_2	STBG-FLEX		\$0	10-22	\$148,000	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$148,000
Total:			\$400,000		\$2,896,100	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$2,896,100
Federal Funding:			\$320,000		\$2,044,000	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$2,044,000
State Funding:			\$0		\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0
Local Funding:			\$80,000		\$852,100	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$852,100

2020-2025: East State St. Mill & Pave: Seneca Way to Mitchell St.



2019-2024: South Albany St. Bridge over Six Mile Creek





Thank you / Questions



Johnathan Licitra
Civil Engineer / Bridge Manager
jlicitra@cityofithaca.org



Bonus: Vision Zero plug

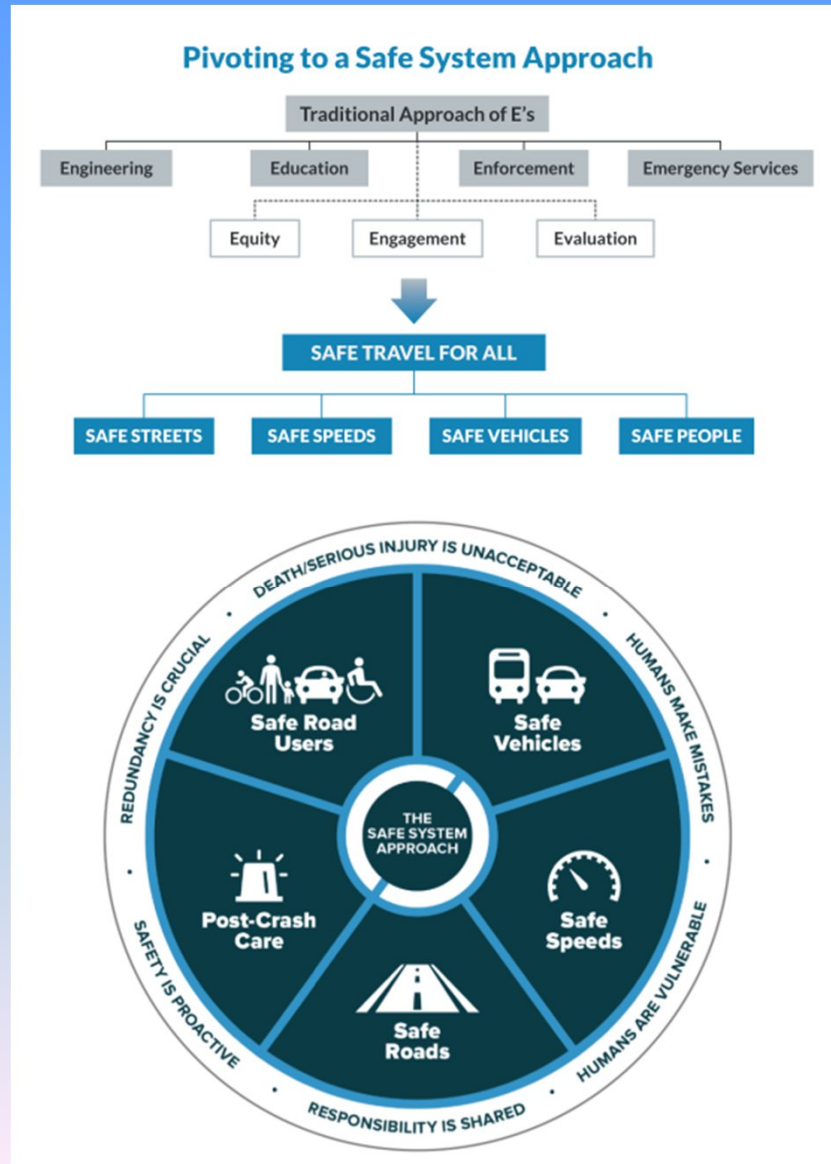


Image from
<https://visionzeronetwork.org/resources/safe-streets-for-all-grants/>



CITY OF ITHACA

108 East Green Street, Ithaca, New York 14850-6590

Department of Public Works
Christine Ibert,

MEMORANDUM

TO: COMMITTEE OF THE WHOLE MEETING B
FROM: John Licitra
DATE: March 18, 2026
RE: Hancock Street Bridge over Cascadilla Creek Replacement Project
ITEM #: 7.2

The Hancock Street over Cascadilla Creek Bridge Replacement Project creates a new capital project. A resolution is needed, design funds will be needed in 2026-2027, but most funding will not be needed until 2029-2030.

ATTACHMENTS:

[Hancock Work Session Memo to Council_Combined_John Licitra.pdf](#)



MEMORANDUM

Date: 19 February 2026

To: Common Council

From: Johnathan Licitra, Civil Engineer, DPW—Engineering Division

RE: Hancock Street over Cascadilla Creek Bridge Replacement Project

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The Hancock Street over Cascadilla Creek Bridge Replacement Project creates a new capital project. Design funds will be needed in 2026-2027, but most funding will not be needed until 2029-2030.

PROJECT HISTORY, BACKGROUND, & ANALYSIS

Hancock St. Bridge was built in 1931—although detailed construction plans are not on-file. In 2009 minor repairs were completed to address a Yellow Structural Flag. Additional surface treatments (i.e. paving) has occurred over the past 90+ years. The current bridge inspection from 7/30/2025 rated the overall bridge condition as “poor” (4.5). A general description of the rating system can be found here: [SNBI Transition Resource Tables.xlsx](#)

POLICY ALIGNMENT STATEMENT

This project aligns with the City’s goal of being more accessible to all community members and improves the longevity of safe, reliable infrastructure. It continues the City’s mission and compliance with the Comprehensive Plan to maintain existing City transportation infrastructure.

QUESTIONS FOR COUNCIL

- If the project is not funded, then what happens to the existing Ithaca-Tompkins County Transportation Council Transportation (ITCTC) Improvement Program (TIP)?
- If the project is not funded, then the bridge will remain open until serious safety flags cause the facility to be temporarily weight listed and potentially closed. Is this an acceptable plan?
- If the project is not completed, then needs will remain; designs and future construction costs will continue to rise. Is this an acceptable strategy?



CITY OF ITHACA | WORK SESSION MEMO

BUDGET IMPLICATIONS & FUNDING

This request is for a new Capital Project. The NYS DOT State Local Agreement (SLA) signing process can take 5-9 months to be finalized. The design process takes 2-3 years depending upon NYS and federal review times with construction scheduled for 2029-2030. Current project funds come from approximately 80% Federal & NYS, and 20% local. The City of Ithaca resolution is written to approve the total project cost up to \$3,282,500 and the City local share is \$656,500.

Additionally, past practice for SLAs that progress into Design and Construction phases, NYS will further reduce the local share to 5% by using NYS Marchiselli Program funds. The current TIP does not detail the Marchiselli fund amounts for future commitments (i.e. Construction funding), but NYS has been funding this program annually.

The City's local share would be covered via capital bonding. The maximum local cost for the design funds in 2026 would be \$19,125 or 5%—although its likely that most of the costs will be incurred in 2027-2028. Specific details from the current SLA for the Design funds are below:

C. Total Project Costs <i>All totals will calculate automatically.</i>			
Total FEDERAL Cost	Total STATE Cost	Total LOCAL Cost	Total ALL SOURCES Cost
\$306,000.00	\$57,375.00	\$19,125.00	\$382,500.00
		Total FEDERAL Cost	\$306,000.00
		Total STATE Cost	\$57,375.00
SFS TOTAL CONTRACT AMOUNT			\$363,375.00

REQUIRED PUBLIC AMENITIES

The proposed bridge design will comply with current NYS DOT highway design guidelines and comply with ADA.

NEXT STEPS

Additional information is found in the attached memo and TIP budget details. A resolution is drafted to fund the full project at the next CC meeting.



CITY OF ITHACA ENGINEERING DEPARTMENT

108 E. Green Street, Rm 204
Ithaca, New York 14850-6590

OFFICE OF THE CITY ENGINEER

Telephone: 607/274-6530

Fax: 607/274-6587

MEMORANDUM

TO: Common Council
FROM: Johnathan Licitra, Civil Engineer
DATE: 12 February 2026
RE: Hancock St. over Cascadilla Creek Bridge Replacement Project, BIN 2210490

Please find attached a resolution seeking Common Council authorization to pay 100% of the Federal/State share of the project cost in the first instance. This project is on the Ithaca-Tompkins County Transportation Council (ITCTC) 2026-2030 Transportation Improvement Program (TIP).

This resolution is required to begin the NYS DOT State Local Agreement signing process which can take 5-9 months. The design process takes 2-3 years depending upon NYS and federal review times with construction scheduled for 2029-2030. Current project costs will be split approximately 80% Federal & NYS, and 20% local. The City of Ithaca resolution is written to approve the total project cost up to \$3,282,500 and the City local share of \$656,500.

The project will include the following:

- Overview: bridge has a 45' span and was built in 1931. The street is classified as a Major Collector and has an Annual Average Daily Traffic of 1,584 vehicles.
- Replacement of all structural and substructure members.
- Replacement of guiderails, curbs, sidewalk, and wearing surface to meet current NYS Highway Design principles and NYS ADA compliance requirements.
- Construction coordination with all utilities (water, sewer, NYSEG).

If you have any questions, please call me @ 607-274-6534 or email me ilicitra@cityofithaca.org

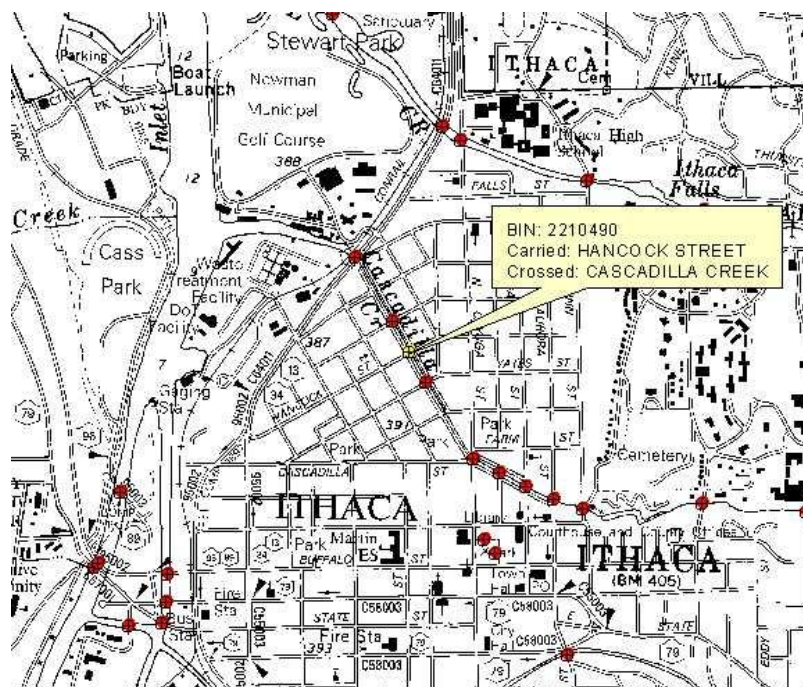


Figure 1. Bridge Location Map



Figure 2. Additional Photos from 2023, 2026

TIP date 2025 **PIN** 375773 **BIN** 2210490
Project Name Hancock Street Bridge over Cascadilla Creek Replacement Project
Sponsor City of Ithaca
Description This project replaces the Hancock Street Bridge over Cascadilla Creek with a longer bridge-BIN 2210490, and performs minor roadway construction on the approaches to the bridge. City of Ithaca, Tompkins CO.

Fund Source: NHPP/MEDIUM URBAN

Project Element	Funding	Date	Obligated	25/26	26/27	27/28	28/29	29/30	5 YR Total
A-1-Scoping	MED URBAN	\$0 10-25	\$0	\$75,000	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$75,000
B-4-Preliminary Design	MED URBAN	\$0 10-25	\$0	\$100,000	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$100,000
C-7-Detailed Design	MED URBAN	\$0 10-25	\$0	\$207,500	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$207,500
G-18-Construction	NHPP	\$0 10-29	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$2,600,000	\$2,600,000
H-22-Inspection	NHPP	\$0 10-29	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$300,000	\$300,000
Total:									
<i>Federal Funding:</i>			\$0	\$382,500	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$2,900,000	\$3,282,500
<i>State Funding:</i>			\$0	\$306,000	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$2,320,000	\$2,626,000
<i>Local Funding:</i>			\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0
			\$0	\$76,500	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$580,000	\$656,500

Hancock Street over Cascadilla Creek Bridge Replacement, BIN 2210490 Project-Resolution

WHEREAS, a project for replacement of the Hancock Street Bridge over Cascadilla Creek, P.I.N. 375773 ("the Project") is eligible for funding under Title 23 U.S. Code as administered by the Federal Highway Administration (FHWA), as amended, that calls for the apportionment of the costs to be borne at the ratio of 80% federal funds and 20% non-federal funds, and

WHEREAS, the City of Ithaca will design, let, and administer all phases of the Project that is identified on the 2026-2030 Transportation Improvement Program budget, and

WHEREAS, the City of Ithaca desires to advance the Project by making a commitment of 100% of the non-federal share of the costs of Scoping, Preliminary Design, Detailed Design, Right of Way (ROW) Incidentals and Acquisition, Construction, and Construction Support and Inspection work for the Project or portions thereof, and

WHEREAS, this project constitutes a reconstruction of facility in-kind on the same site as well as maintenance or repair involving no substantial change in an existing facility, and is therefore a Type II action under the National Environmental Policy Act (NEPA) Regulation and in accordance with 6 NYCRR Part 617 requiring no environmental review; and

Now therefore, the Common Council, duly convened does hereby

RESOLVED, that the Common Council hereby approves the Project; and be it hereby further

RESOLVED, that the Common Council hereby authorizes the City of Ithaca to pay in the first instance 100% of the federal and non-federal share of the Scoping, Preliminary Design, Detailed Design, ROW Incidentals and ROW Acquisition, Construction, and Construction Support and Inspection work for the project thereof; and be it further

RESOLVED, that Common Council hereby establishes Capital Project # ____ in an amount not to exceed the sum of \$3,282,500.00 is hereby appropriated from the issuance of Serial Bonds with repayment for the federal and NYS share being \$2,626,000 and the City's estimated share of the project cost not to exceed 20% or \$656,500.00 and made available to cover the cost of participation in the above phases of the Project; and it is further

RESOLVED, that the Common Council of the City of Ithaca hereby agrees that the City of Ithaca shall be responsible for all costs of the Project, including costs which exceed the amount of reimbursement available from the awarded amount to the City of Ithaca, and it is further

RESOLVED, that in the event the costs of the Project exceed the amount appropriated above, Common Council of the City of Ithaca shall convene as soon as possible to appropriate said

excess amount immediately upon the notification by the DPW division of Engineering staff and/or New York State Department of Transportation (NYSDOT) thereof, and it is further

RESOLVED, that the City Manager of the City of Ithaca of the County of Tompkins be and is hereby authorized to sign all necessary Agreements, certifications, and reimbursement requests with NYSDOT to secure Federal Aid and Marchiselli Aid on behalf of the City of Ithaca and the Superintendent of Public Works is authorized to sign all necessary construction documents, contracts, certifications and reimbursement requests, in connection with the advancement or approval of the Project and providing for the administration of the Project and the municipality's funding of the Project costs, and it is further

RESOLVED, that the Superintendent of Public Works be and is hereby authorized to administer the above project, and it is further

RESOLVED, that the City of Ithaca will be responsible for all maintenance of the Project; and it is further

RESOLVED, that a certified copy of this resolution be filed with the New York State Commissioner of Transportation by attaching it to any necessary Agreement in connection with the Project, and it is further

RESOLVED, that this Resolution shall take effect immediately.



CITY OF ITHACA

108 East Green Street, Ithaca, New York 14850-6590

Dept of Public Works-Engineering
Christine Ibert,

MEMORANDUM

TO: COMMITTEE OF THE WHOLE MEETING B
FROM: John Licitra
DATE: March 18, 2026
RE: East State Street Rehabilitation Project
ITEM #: 7.3

The East State Street Rehabilitation from Mitchell St. to Ithaca East City Line creates a new capital project. A resolution is needed, design funds will be needed in 2026-2027, but most funding will not be needed until 2029-2030.

ATTACHMENTS:

[East St St Rehab Work Session Memo to Council_John Licitra.pdf](#)



MEMORANDUM

Date: 19 February 2026

To: Common Council

From: Johnathan Licitra, Civil Engineer, DPW—Engineering Division

RE: East State Street Rehabilitation Project

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The East State Street Rehabilitation from Mitchell St. to Ithaca East City Line creates a new capital project. Design funds will be needed in 2026-2027, but most funding will not be needed until 2029-2030.

PROJECT HISTORY, BACKGROUND, & ANALYSIS

East State Street, also known as State Touring Route 79, is located on the east hill of Ithaca. In 2005, a mill and pave surface treatment was applied. Over the past years, NYSEG Gas utility has replaced gas mains and services. This project location would continue from where the last street repair project limits left-off in 2024.

POLICY ALIGNMENT STATEMENT

This project aligns with the City's goal of being more accessible to all community members and improves the longevity of safe, reliable infrastructure. It continues the City's mission and compliance with the Comprehensive Plan to maintain existing City transportation infrastructure.

QUESTIONS FOR COUNCIL

- If the project is not funded, then what happens to the existing Ithaca-Tompkins County Transportation Council Transportation (ITCTC) Improvement Program (TIP)?
- If the project is not funded, then the road surface conditions will continue to degrade. Is this an acceptable plan?
- If the project is not completed, then needs will remain; designs and future construction costs will continue to rise. Is this an acceptable strategy?



CITY OF ITHACA | WORK SESSION MEMO

BUDGET IMPLICATIONS & FUNDING

This request is for a new Capital Project. The NYS DOT State Local Agreement (SLA) signing process can take 5-9 months to be finalized. The design process takes 2-3 years depending upon NYS and federal review times with construction scheduled for 2029-2030. Current project funds come from approximately 80% Federal & NYS, and 20% local. The City of Ithaca resolution is written to approve the total project cost up to \$3,803,500 and the City local share is \$760,700.

Additionally, past practice for SLAs that progress into Design and Construction phases, NYS will further reduce the local share to 5% by using NYS Marchiselli Program funds. The current TIP does not detail the Marchiselli fund amounts for future commitments (i.e. Construction funding), but NYS has been funding this program annually.

The City's local share would be covered via capital bonding. The maximum local cost for the design funds in 2026 would be \$31,800 or 5%—although its likely that most of the costs will be incurred in 2027-2028. Specific details from the current SLA for the Design funds are below:

C. Total Project Costs <i>All totals will calculate automatically.</i>			
Total FEDERAL Cost	Total STATE Cost	Total LOCAL Cost	Total ALL SOURCES Cost
\$508,800.00	\$95,400.00	\$31,800.00	\$636,000.00
		Total FEDERAL Cost	\$508,800.00
		Total STATE Cost	\$95,400.00
SFS TOTAL CONTRACT AMOUNT			\$604,200.00

REQUIRED PUBLIC AMENITIES

The proposed highway design will comply with current NYS DOT highway design guidelines and comply with ADA.

NEXT STEPS

Additional information is found in the attached memo and TIP budget details. A resolution is drafted to fund the full project at the next CC meeting.



CITY OF ITHACA ENGINEERING DEPARTMENT

108 E. Green Street, Rm 204
Ithaca, New York 14850-6590

OFFICE OF THE CITY ENGINEER

Telephone: 607/274-6530

Fax: 607/274-6587

MEMORANDUM

TO: Common Council
FROM: Johnathan Licitra, Civil Engineer
DATE: 19 February 2026
RE: East State St. Rehabilitation, Mitchell St. to Ithaca E. City Line Project

Please find attached a resolution seeking Common Council authorization to pay 100% of the Federal/State/City share of the project cost in the first instance. This project is on the Ithaca-Tompkins County Transportation Council (ITCTC) 2026-2030 Transportation Improvement Program (TIP).

This resolution is required to begin the NYS DOT State Local Agreement signing process which can take 5-9 months. The design process takes 2-3 years depending upon NYS and Federal review times with construction scheduled for 2029-2030. Current project funds come from approximately 80% Federal & NYS, and 20% local. The City of Ithaca resolution is written to approve the total project cost up to \$3,803,500 and the City local share is \$760,700.

The project will include the following:

- Major road rehabilitation of East State St. (NYS Touring Route 79) from Mitchell St. intersection to the Ithaca East City line—approx. 0.7 miles in road length. The street is classified as a Principal Arterial and has an Annual Average Daily Traffic of 5,606 vehicles.
- Replacement of wearing surface, guiderails, curbs, sidewalk, storm sewer and retaining wall conditions to meet current NYS Highway Design principles and NYS ADA compliance requirements.
- Construction coordination with all utilities (water, sewer, NYSEG).

If you have any questions, please call me @ 607-274-6534 or email me jlicitra@cityofithaca.org

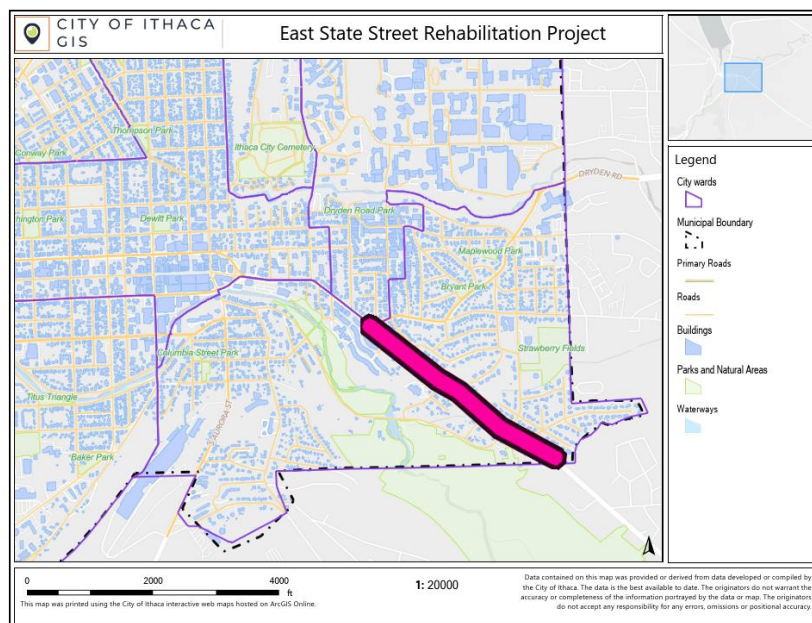


Figure 1. Project Location Map



Figure 2. Photos from 2024, 2026

TIP date 2025 **PIN** 375772 **BIN**

Project Name East State Street Rehabilitation

Sponsor City of Ithaca

Description Rehabilitates East State Street from Mitchell St to Ithaca East City Line. Work will address pavement failings, storm sewer and retaining wall conditions, and pedestrian facilities including sidewalks, crosswalks, and ramps. City of Ithaca, Tompkins CO.

Fund Source: NHPP/MED URBAN/STBG-FLEX

Project Element	Funding	Date	Obligated	Date	25/26	26/27	27/28	28/29	29/30	5 YR Total
A-1-Scoping	NHPP		\$0	11-25	\$100,000	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$100,000
B-4-Preliminary Design	NHPP		\$0	11-25	\$286,000	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$286,000
C-7-Detailed Design	NHPP		\$0	11-25	\$250,000	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$250,000
G-18-Construction	NHPP		\$0	11-29	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$929,000	\$929,000
G-19-Construction_1	STBG-FLEX		\$0	11-29	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$1,571,000	\$1,571,000
G-20-Construction_2	MED URBAN		\$0	11-29	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$292,500	\$292,500
H-22-Inspection	MEDIUM URBAN		\$0	11-29	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$375,000	\$375,000
Total:			\$0		\$636,000	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$3,167,500	\$3,803,500
Federal Funding:			\$0		\$508,800	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$2,534,000	\$3,042,800
State Funding:			\$0		\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0
Local Funding:			\$0		\$127,200	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$633,500	\$760,700

East State Street Rehabilitation, PIN 375772 Project-Resolution

WHEREAS, a project for rehabilitation of the East State Street from Mitchell Street to Ithaca East City Line, P.I.N. 375772 (“the Project”) is eligible for funding under Title 23 U.S. Code as administered by the Federal Highway Administration (FHWA), as amended, that calls for the apportionment of the costs to be borne at the ratio of 80% federal funds and 20% non-federal funds, and

WHEREAS, the City of Ithaca will design, let, and administer all phases of the Project that is identified on the 2026-2030 Transportation Improvement Program budget, and

WHEREAS, the City of Ithaca desires to advance the Project by making a commitment of 100% of the non-Federal share of the costs of Scoping, Preliminary Design, Detailed Design, Right of Way (ROW) Incidentals and Acquisition, Construction, and Construction Support and Inspection work for the Project or portions thereof, and

WHEREAS, this project constitutes a reconstruction of facility in-kind on the same site as well as maintenance or repair involving no substantial change in an existing facility, and is therefore a Type II action under the National Environmental Policy Act (NEPA) Regulation and in accordance with 6 NYCRR Part 617 requiring no environmental review; and

Now therefore, the Common Council, duly convened does hereby

RESOLVED, that the Common Council hereby approves the Project; and be it hereby further

RESOLVED, that the Common Council hereby authorizes the City of Ithaca to pay in the first instance 100% of the federal and non-federal share of the Scoping, Preliminary Design, Detailed Design, ROW Incidentals and ROW Acquisition, Construction, and Construction Support and Inspection work for the project thereof; and be it further

RESOLVED, that Common Council hereby establishes Capital Project #_____ in an amount not to exceed the sum of \$3,803,500.00 is hereby appropriated from the issuance of Serial Bonds with repayment for the Federal and NYS share being \$3,042,800 and the City’s estimated share of the project cost not to exceed 20% or \$760,700.00 and made available to cover the cost of participation in the above phases of the Project; and it is further

RESOLVED, that the Common Council of the City of Ithaca hereby agrees that the City of Ithaca shall be responsible for all costs of the Project, including costs which exceed the amount of reimbursement available from the awarded amount to the City of Ithaca, and it is further

RESOLVED, that in the event the costs of the Project exceed the amount appropriated above, Common Council of the City of Ithaca shall convene as soon as possible to appropriate said

excess amount immediately upon the notification by the Engineering staff and/or New York State Department of Transportation (NYSDOT) thereof, and it is further

RESOLVED, that the City Manager of the City of Ithaca of the County of Tompkins be and is hereby authorized to sign all necessary Agreements, certifications, or reimbursement requests with NYSDOT to secure Federal Aid and Marchiselli Aid on behalf of the City of Ithaca and the Superintendent of Public Works is authorized to sign all necessary construction documents, contracts, certifications and reimbursement requests, in connection with the advancement or approval of the Project and providing for the administration of the Project and the municipality's funding of the Project costs, and it is further

RESOLVED, that the Superintendent of Public Works be and is hereby authorized to administer the above project, and it is further

RESOLVED, that the City of Ithaca will be responsible for all maintenance of the Project; and it is further

RESOLVED, that a certified copy of this resolution be filed with the New York State Commissioner of Transportation by attaching it to any necessary Agreement in connection with the Project, and it is further

RESOLVED, That this Resolution shall take effect immediately.



CITY OF ITHACA

108 East Green Street, Ithaca, New York 14850-6590

Dept of Public Works-Engineering
Christine Ibert,

MEMORANDUM

TO: COMMITTEE OF THE WHOLE MEETING B
FROM: John Licitra
DATE: March 18, 2026
RE: Spencer Road Improvement Project
ITEM #: 7.4

The Spencer Road Improvements from the Elmira Road / S. Albany Street roundabout to Stone Quarry Road creates a new capital project. A resolution is needed, design funds will be needed in 2026-2027, but most funding will not be needed until 2028-2029.

ATTACHMENTS:

[Spencer Rd Improvements Work Session Memo to_John Licitra.pdf](#)



MEMORANDUM

Date: 19 February 2026

To: Common Council

From: Johnathan Licitra, Civil Engineer, DPW—Engineering Division

RE: Spencer Road Improvement Project

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The Spencer Road Improvements from the Elmira Road / S. Albany Street roundabout to Stone Quarry Road creates a new capital project. Design funds will be needed in 2026-2027, but most funding will not be needed until 2028-2029.

PROJECT HISTORY, BACKGROUND, & ANALYSIS

Spencer Road is located on the southside of Ithaca. In 1997, the road received a full depth pavement replacement and an asphalt skim coat treatment occurred in 2024. In 2017, the Sidewalk Improvement District work plan paid for preliminary design plans to alleviate pedestrian safety concerns. Pedestrian safety enhancements have not occurred due to funding limitations.

POLICY ALIGNMENT STATEMENT

This project aligns with the City's goal of being more accessible to all community members and improves the longevity of safe, reliable infrastructure. It continues the City's mission and compliance with the Comprehensive Plan to maintain existing City transportation infrastructure.

QUESTIONS FOR COUNCIL

- If the project is not funded, then what happens to the existing Ithaca-Tompkins County Transportation Council Transportation (ITCTC) Improvement Program (TIP)?
- If the project is not funded, then the road surface conditions will continue to degrade. Is this an acceptable plan?
- If the project is not completed, then needs will remain; designs and future construction costs will continue to rise. Is this an acceptable strategy?



CITY OF ITHACA | WORK SESSION MEMO

BUDGET IMPLICATIONS & FUNDING

This request is for a new Capital Project. The NYS DOT State Local Agreement (SLA) signing process can take 5-9 months to be finalized. The design process takes 2-3 years depending upon NYS and federal review times with construction scheduled for 2028-2029. Current project funds come from approximately 80% Federal NYS, and 20% local. The City of Ithaca resolution is written to approve the total project cost up to \$1,088,500 and the City local share is \$217,700.

Additionally, past practice for SLAs that progress into Design and Construction phases, NYS will further reduce the local share to 5% by using NYS Marchiselli Program funds. The current TIP does not detail the Marchiselli fund amounts for future commitments (i.e. Construction funding), but NYS has been funding this program annually.

The City's local share would be covered via capital bonding. The maximum local cost for the design funds in 2026 would be \$14,250 or 5%—although its likely that most of the costs will be incurred in 2027-2028. Specific details from the current SLA for the Design funds are below:

C. Total Project Costs <i>All totals will calculate automatically.</i>			
Total FEDERAL Cost	Total STATE Cost	Total LOCAL Cost	Total ALL SOURCES Cost
\$228,000.00	\$42,750.00	\$14,250.00	\$285,000.00
		Total FEDERAL Cost	\$228,000.00
		Total STATE Cost	\$42,750.00
SFS TOTAL CONTRACT AMOUNT			\$270,750.00

REQUIRED PUBLIC AMENITIES

The proposed highway design will comply with current NYS DOT highway design guidelines and comply with ADA.

NEXT STEPS

Additional information is found in the attached memo and TIP budget details. A resolution is drafted to fund the full project at the next CC meeting.



CITY OF ITHACA ENGINEERING DEPARTMENT

108 E. Green Street, Rm 204
Ithaca, New York 14850-6590

OFFICE OF THE CITY ENGINEER

Telephone: 607/274-6530

Fax: 607/274-6587

MEMORANDUM

TO: Common Council
FROM: Johnathan Licitra, Civil Engineer
DATE: 19 February 2026
RE: Spencer Road Improvement Project: from the Elmira Road / S. Albany Street roundabout to Stone Quarry Road

Please find attached a resolution seeking Common Council authorization to pay 100% of the Federal/State/City share of the project cost in the first instance. This project is on the Ithaca-Tompkins County Transportation Council (ITCTC) 2026-2030 Transportation Improvement Program (TIP).

This resolution is required to begin the NYS DOT State Local Agreement signing process which can take 5-9 months. The design process takes 2-3 years depending upon NYS and Federal review times with construction scheduled for 2028-2029. Current project funds come from approximately 80% Federal & NYS, and 20% local. The City of Ithaca resolution is written to approve the total project cost up to \$1,088,500 and the City local share is \$217,700.

The project will include the following:

- Major road rehabilitation of Spencer Road from the Elmira Road / S. Albany Street roundabout to Stone Quarry Road—approx. 0.4 miles in road length. The street is classified as a Major Collector and has an Annual Average Daily Traffic of 3,903 vehicles.
- Replacement of wearing surface, guiderails, curbs, new sidewalks and crosswalks, storm sewer and retaining wall conditions to meet current NYS Highway Design principles and NYS ADA compliance requirements. Note: The current road profile is quite narrow at some sections, and offers limited-to-no pedestrian safety areas due to steep embankments and deep ditches.
- Construction coordination with all utilities (water, sewer, NYSEG).

If you have any questions, please call me @ 607-274-6534 or email me jlicitra@cityofithaca.org

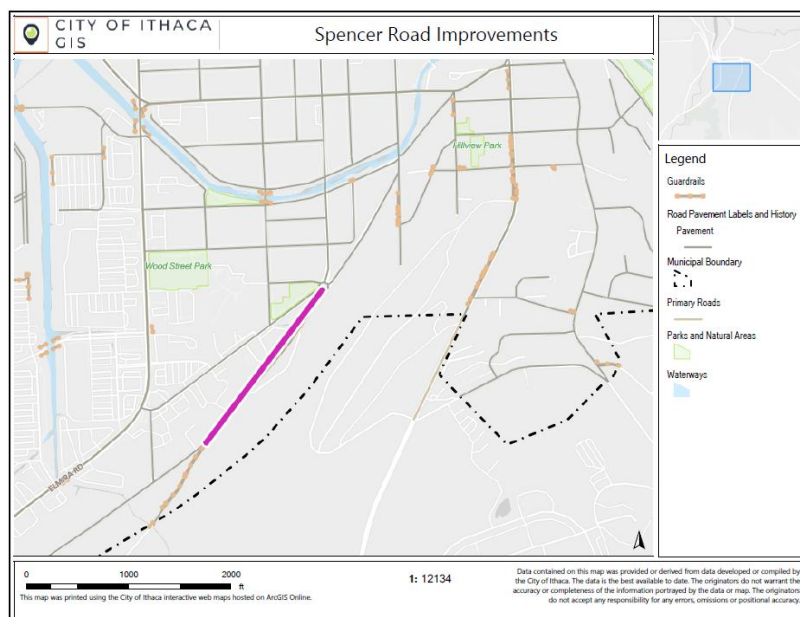


Figure 1. Project Location Map



Figure 2. Photos from 2024, 2026

TIP date 2025
Project Name Spencer Road Improvements
Sponsor City of Ithaca
Description Makes pedestrian, road, and culvert improvements on Spencer Road from the Elmira Rd Roundabout to Quarry Rd. Improvements include building a sidewalk and crosswalks along one side of the road, rehabilitating four culverts, replacing the existing guide rail, relocating utility poles and drainage structures, and milling 4 inches of asphalt on this road segment. City of Ithaca, Tompkins CO.

PIN 375774 **BIN**

Fund Source: MEDIUM URBAN/STBG-FLEX

Project Element	Funding	Date	Obligated	Date	25/26	26/27	27/28	28/29	29/30	5 YR Total
A-1-Scoping	MED URBAN		\$0	10-25	\$50,000	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$50,000
B-4-Preliminary Design	MED URBAN		\$0	10-25	\$75,000	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$75,000
C-7-Detailed Design	MED URBAN		\$0	10-25	\$160,000	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$160,000
G-18-Construction	MED URBAN		\$0	10-28	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$466,000	\$0	\$835,000
G-19-Construction_2	STBG-FLEX		\$0	10-28	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$252,500	\$0	\$252,500
H-22-Inspection	MED URBAN		\$0	10-28	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$85,000	\$0	\$85,000
Total:										
<i>Federal Funding:</i>					\$285,000	\$0	\$0	\$803,500	\$0	\$1,088,500
<i>State Funding:</i>					\$228,000	\$0	\$0	\$642,800	\$0	\$870,800
<i>Local Funding:</i>					\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0	\$0
					\$57,000	\$0	\$0	\$160,700	\$0	\$217,700

Spencer Road Improvements, PIN 375774 Project-Resolution

WHEREAS, a project for rehabilitation of Spencer Road from the Elmira Road / S. Albany Street roundabout to Stone Quarry Road, P.I.N. 375774 ("the Project") is eligible for funding under Title 23 U.S. Code as administered by the Federal Highway Administration (FHWA), as amended, that calls for the apportionment of the costs to be borne at the ratio of 80% federal funds and 20% non-federal funds, and

WHEREAS, the City of Ithaca will design, let, and administer all phases of the Project that is identified on the 2026-2030 Transportation Improvement Program budget, and

WHEREAS, the City of Ithaca desires to advance the Project by making a commitment of 100% of the non-Federal share of the costs of Scoping, Preliminary Design, Detailed Design, Right of Way (ROW) Incidentals and Acquisition, Construction, and Construction Support and Inspection work for the Project or portions thereof, and

WHEREAS, this project constitutes a reconstruction of facility in-kind on the same site as well as maintenance or repair involving no substantial change in an existing facility, and is therefore a Type II action under the National Environmental Policy Act (NEPA) Regulation and in accordance with 6 NYCRR Part 617 requiring no environmental review; and

Now therefore, the Common Council, duly convened does hereby

RESOLVED, that the Common Council hereby approves the Project; and be it hereby further

RESOLVED, that the Common Council hereby authorizes the City of Ithaca to pay in the first instance 100% of the federal and non-federal share of the Scoping, Preliminary Design, Detailed Design, ROW Incidentals and ROW Acquisition, Construction, and Construction Support and Inspection work for the project thereof; and be it further

RESOLVED, that Common Council hereby establishes Capital Project #_____ in an amount not to exceed the sum of \$1,088,500.00 is hereby appropriated from the issuance of Serial Bonds with repayment for the Federal and NYS share being \$870,800 and the City's estimated share of the project cost not to exceed 20% or \$217,700.00 and made available to cover the cost of participation in the above phases of the Project; and it is further

RESOLVED, that the Common Council of the City of Ithaca hereby agrees that the City of Ithaca shall be responsible for all costs of the Project, including costs which exceed the amount of reimbursement available from the awarded amount to the City of Ithaca, and it is further

RESOLVED, that in the event the costs of the Project exceed the amount appropriated above, Common Council of the City of Ithaca shall convene as soon as possible to appropriate said

excess amount immediately upon the notification by the Engineering staff and/or New York State Department of Transportation (NYSDOT) thereof, and it is further

RESOLVED, that the City Manager of the City of Ithaca of the County of Tompkins be and is hereby authorized to sign all necessary Agreements, certifications, or reimbursement requests with NYSDOT to secure Federal Aid and Marchiselli Aid on behalf of the City of Ithaca and the Superintendent of Public Works is authorized to sign all necessary construction documents, contracts, certifications and reimbursement requests, in connection with the advancement or approval of the Project and providing for the administration of the Project and the municipality's funding of the Project costs, and it is further

RESOLVED, that the Superintendent of Public Works be and is hereby authorized to administer the above project, and it is further

RESOLVED, that the City of Ithaca will be responsible for all maintenance of the Project; and it is further

RESOLVED, that a certified copy of this resolution be filed with the New York State Commissioner of Transportation by attaching it to any necessary Agreement in connection with the Project, and it is further

RESOLVED, That this Resolution shall take effect immediately.



CITY OF ITHACA

108 East Green Street, Ithaca, New York 14850-6590

Mayor's Office
Shaniqua Lewis, Deputy City Clerk

MEMORANDUM

TO: COMMITTEE OF THE WHOLE MEETING B
FROM: Mayor Robert Cantelmo & Acting City Manager, Dominick Recckio
DATE: March 18, 2026
RE: City Policy Priorities
ITEM #: 8.1

Resolution Establishing City Policy Priorities for Executive Administration 2026.

ATTACHMENTS:

[CC-Master Priorities Resolution Finalized.pdf](#)

Resolution Establishing City Policy Priorities for Executive Administration 2026

WHEREAS, the City of Ithaca operates under a Mayor-Council-Manager form of government, in which the city manager serves as the responsible party for the daily administration of government and the policies and directives of the mayor and Common Council; and

WHEREAS, on September 3, 2025 the Common Council adopted the vision statements and strategic goals drafted by the Mayor's advisory committees on legislative policy (Appendix A); and

WHEREAS, the Mayor was charged by Council to work with the administration to develop and bring forward draft proposals, amendments to existing laws, and policy briefings for consideration of the Common Council that reflects said adopted findings; and

WHEREAS, on December 3, 2025 the Mayor designated and Council affirmed that Deputy City Manager Recckio as Acting City Manager effective January 1, 2026 and charged the Acting City Manager to "deliver and implement, in consultation with the mayor, a 2026 Executive Workplan for Common Council's legislative priorities and direction, aligning departmental goals, identifying responsible staff and timelines. After approval by Common Council, the acting city manager shall provide quarterly administrative performance reports summarizing departmental outcomes, project milestones, and progress toward legislative objectives;" and

WHEREAS, Council committed, in that authorizing resolution, to adopting policy priorities to guide the 2026 Executive Workplan no later than February 2026, but required additional time to confer, deliberate, and prioritize; and

WHEREAS, the Mayoral advisory groups have circulated memoranda to relevant city departments and received their feedback about bandwidth, achievability, and scope; and

WHEREAS, the Mayor has refined the items within each advisory memo in consultation with the Acting City Manager to ensure they are Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, and Time-bound for 2026 and, as appropriate, the 2027 budgeting process; now therefore be it

RESOLVED, that the Acting City Manager will take all appropriate steps to implement and administer the policy goals of the City of Ithaca stated in this resolution; and be it further

RESOLVED, that the Acting City Manager, in consultation with the Mayor, will develop, deliver, and implement, after adoption by the Common Council, an executive workplan with quarterly quantitative and qualitative performance updates, pursuant to the procedures and requirements outlined in "Resolution of the Common Council of the City of Ithaca Establishing Oversight and Performance Reporting Protocols for the Acting City Manager" (December 3, 2025); and be it further

RESOLVED, that the executive workplan shall be structured to include, for each priority in this resolution, Specific, Measurable, Achievable, Relevant, and Time-bound goals; quarterly milestones; the lead department or responsible official; and performance measures for outputs and policy outcomes that can be objectively evaluated and transparently tracked by the Mayor, Common Council, and the public, and that quarterly performance updates shall identify progress made, missed milestones, reasons for delay, and corrective actions, and any policy or resource decisions needed from the Mayor or Common Council; and be it further

RESOLVED, that progress toward the goals and milestones contained in the executive workplan and quarterly performance updates shall inform the Mayor and Common Council's ongoing evaluation of administrative performance and progress toward adopted legislative priorities; and be it further

RESOLVED, that this resolution take effect upon adoption; and be it finally

RESOLVED, that the Mayor and Common Council adopt the following legislative priorities for 2026-2027:::

A. Housing

- a. It is the policy of the City to establish a citywide policy requiring minimum residential densities of 20 dwelling units per acre in designated urban core areas and 10 dwelling units per acre in urban edge areas. These density targets may be implemented through, without limitation, zoning amendments, code modifications, and planning documents to support housing affordability, sustainability, and long-term growth. This policy is consistent with the 2015 Comprehensive Plan¹ and supersedes any conflicting prior policy guidance.
- b. Request that the Zoning Advisory Committee recommend to the Mayor and Common Council a comprehensive zoning reform package to modernize land use regulations in alignment with adopted housing, equity, and sustainability goals to promote density goals, middle housing, by-right development, parking mandate reform or abolition, and affordable housing and cooperative ownership incentives.
- c. Prepare and submit for the consideration of the Mayor and Common Council Objective Design Standards and associated administrative reforms that shift residential and mixed-use development toward predictable, ministerial approval processes and limit discretionary review processes and establish predictable timelines.

B. Economic & Community Development

- a. It is the policy of the City to advance focused planning and coordination efforts to support revitalization of the West MLK Street Corridor, including assessment of land use conditions, infrastructure needs, business mix, and barriers to reinvestment. Emphasize community engagement, alignment with housing and transportation initiatives, and identification of near-term public actions that can catalyze private and nonprofit investment; and
- b. Prepare and submit for the consideration of the Mayor and Common Council code modernization and streamlining efforts to reduce barriers to business formation, expansion, and redevelopment, particularly for small businesses, locally owned enterprises, and neighborhood-level commercial nodes.
- c. Prepare and submit for the consideration of the Mayor and Common Council a plan and associated costs to develop a comprehensive, regularly updated economic data dashboard for City policymakers to track local economic conditions, performance trends, and equity outcomes. The dashboard should integrate indicators such as employment and wages, business activity, commercial vacancy, housing affordability, tax base trends, and neighborhood-level investment, and be designed to inform policy decisions, budget deliberations, and program evaluation.

C. Public Works & Operations

- a. It is the policy of the City to strengthen coordination between Public Works capital planning and citywide housing, sustainability, and accessibility objectives, including alignment of street, utility, and right-of-way investments with development activity, climate resilience priorities, ADA compliance, and long-range land use plans.
- b. Advance flood mitigation actions to protect city neighborhoods impacted by the revised FEMA flood maps. Prepare and submit for the consideration of the Mayor and Common Council any legislation, capital investments, or administrative actions necessary to support this infrastructure and public safety priority.
- c. Prepare and submit for the consideration of the Mayor and Common Council a comprehensive, long-range Facilities Master Plan addressing the condition, capacity, location, and future needs of City-owned facilities, to inform capital planning, budget decisions, facilities maintenance, workforce needs, and service delivery over the next decade.

D. Finance & Administration

¹ See page 37 of the Plan Ithaca, citing low-density residential at 10 dwelling units per acre, medium-density between 10-20 dwelling units per acre, and higher-density residential as significantly more.

- a. It is the policy of the City to advance a coordinated effort to bring financial records, reconciliations, and supporting documentation into a consistent, auditable state for fiscal years 2022 through 2025. Fully implement the City’s Corrective Action Plan from the most recent NYS Audit.
- b. Implement Council policies adopted in November 2025 requiring permanent (1) general fund balance policy; and (2) debt reduction, BAN conversion, and equipment replacement strategies.
- c. Prepare and submit for the consideration of the Mayor and Common Council a plan and associated costs to develop performance-informed budgeting frameworks and long-range capital planning for 2028 budget cycle and beyond.

E. Sustainability, Adaptability, and Resilience

- a. It is the policy of the City to support implementation of the City’s adopted Climate Action Plan by having staff prepare and submit for the consideration of the Mayor and Common Council appropriate legislation or strategies , focusing on the domains of housing, labor, public health, racial equity, power reliability, and emergency response.
- b. Prepare and submit for the consideration of the Mayor and Common Council a capital project budget that complies with adopted Justice50 policy.

F. Human Services and Quality of Life

- a. It is the policy of the City to promote participatory programs, community-driven planning efforts, and support for civic infrastructure that fosters trust, engagement, and shared stewardship of public spaces.
- b. Prepare and submit for the consideration of the Mayor and Common Council the establishment of a standalone Parks Department or improved operational plan to improve central planning, service delivery, maintenance standards, and community outcomes related to parks and public space.

G. Public Safety

- a. It is the policy of the to stabilize and fully staff all public safety-oriented positions within City government. Efforts to implement this policy should include preparation and submission for the consideration of the Mayor and Common Council operational and budgetary plans, and should include, including targeted recruitment, retention, and training strategies. Emphasis should be placed on restoring minimum staffing levels necessary to maintain service reliability, responder safety, and community trust.
- b. Evaluate the first-year of “ROOTS” implementation and prepare and submit to the Mayor and Common Council operational or policy adjustments in line with the local and national best practices emerging from Reimagining Public Safety efforts.

H. Intergovernmental Relations

- a. Pursuant to §C-11(A), support the Mayor in their duties and responsibilities for intergovernmental advocacy and representation around efforts to secure operational and capital grant funding, public and private economic investment, and advocacy for such federal, state, or regional policies or regulatory actions that they may deem appropriate or the Council may direct them to pursue.
- b. Prepare and submit for the consideration of the Mayor and Common Council such intergovernmental MOUs, contracts, or service sharing agreements that will benefit the residents of the City of Ithaca.

Appendix A

Adopted September 3, 2025

Housing

Kayla Matos, Ducson Nguyen, Tiffany Kumar, Clyde Lederman

Vision Statement

Ensure every Ithacan has access to safe, affordable, and dignified housing, while enabling smart, sustainable growth that strengthens neighborhoods and our local economy.

Strategic Goals

1. Add 4,300 new housing units by 2030, including 1,600 deeply affordable units and 900 new for-sale units to support pathways to ownership to address demand, reduce upward pressure on prices, and enable population and workforce growth.
2. Reduce housing cost burden by 10% citywide, focusing on renters and low-to-moderate income households, through expanded affordability tools, tenant protection measures, and housing supply interventions.
3. End unsheltered homelessness through a Housing First approach and the development of permanent supportive housing, in partnership with County and nonprofit providers.

Economic and Community Development

Kayla Matos, Kris Haines-Sharp, Patrick Kuehl, Margaret Fabrizio

Vision Statement

Advance a resilient, inclusive, and innovative-driven local economy that reflects community values – one grounded in broad-based ownership, quality employment, cultural vitality, and equitable opportunity. This vision will be realized through strategic land use, investment in sustainable infrastructure, and vibrant commercial corridors.

Strategic Goals

1. Double the City's GDP growth rate over five years through coordinated land use, infrastructure, and innovation investments.
2. Expand access to economic opportunity, especially for historically underrepresented and marginalized communities, through targeted workforce development, public-private partnerships, new business development support, code modernization and streamlining, and neighborhood-level investment.
3. Strengthen and diversify neighborhood commercial nodes and downtown through planning, capital investment, and small-scale manufacturing or green production zones.

Public Works and Operations

Ducson Nguyen, Kris Haines-Sharp, David Shapiro

Vision Statement

Deliver efficient, equitable, and climate-resilient public infrastructure and operations that enhance quality of life, support sustainable growth, and strengthen community trust between the community and local government. Through modernization and innovation, ensure that City services are responsive, future-ready, and inclusive of all residents.

Strategic Goals

1. Reinvest in and maintain critical infrastructure systems—including streets, water, sewer, and stormwater—to meet current and anticipated future demand. Reduce deferred maintenance, enhance reliability, and ensure systems are adaptable to climate change and population growth.
2. Improve operational efficiency through targeted investments in personnel, training, fleet modernization, technology upgrades, and integrated data systems. Embed equity and accountability into operational practices to ensure consistent, high-quality service and communication across all neighborhoods.

3. Coordinate infrastructure and capital planning with citywide sustainability, accessibility, and housing objectives. Strengthen interdepartmental collaboration, integrate community input, and use capital investments as tools to advance long-term priorities.

Finance

David Shapiro, Tiffany Kumar, Clyde Lederman

Vision Statement

Promote a stable, transparent, and forward-looking fiscal foundation that sustains core services, enables strategic investment, and ensures equitable resource allocation across the community.

Strategic Goals

1. Maintain long-term structural balance and proactively pursue financial resilience while keeping annual tax levy increases within the State tax cap.
2. Expand non-property tax revenue through economic growth, external partnerships, and innovation in service delivery.
3. Improve transparency, equity, and performance in budgeting through participatory processes, performance metrics, and long-term financial planning, policies, and forecasting.

Public Safety

Phoebe Brown, Ducson Nguyen, Tiffany Kumar

Vision Statement

Advance a holistic, equitable, and community-centered public safety system that prioritizes prevention, trust-building, and well-coordinated emergency response.

Strategic Goals

1. Expand and institutionalize unarmed and community-based crisis response as a complement to traditional policing.
2. Strengthen coordination and communication among police, fire, EMS, and mental health responders to ensure effective, equitable, and timely emergency responses.
3. Build trust and accountability through proactive engagement, transparency, and recruitment strategies that reflect the values and diversity of our community.

Sustainability, Adaptability, and Resilience

Kris Haines-Sharp, David Shapiro, Pierre Saint-Perez, Patrick Kuehl

Vision Statement

Build a just, climate-resilient, and regenerative future by embedding sustainability, adaptability, and resilience into all aspects of City planning, policy, and operations. Create systems that not only mitigate environmental harm but actively restore ecological health, protect vulnerable populations, and position the community to thrive amid a changing climate and evolving economic landscape.

Strategic Goals

1. Advance emissions reductions across buildings, transportation, and infrastructure in alignment with the Ithaca Green New Deal, state climate targets, and global best practices. Leverage partnerships, policies, and investments to scale impact quickly and equitably.
2. Strengthen the community's capacity to withstand and recover from climate-related shocks, including extreme weather, energy disruptions, and threats to food and water security. Prioritize support for vulnerable populations and neighborhoods most at risk.
3. Embed sustainability, adaptation, and equity into municipal budgeting, capital planning, procurement, land use, and departmental decision-making. Develop consistent frameworks and accountability tools to ensure climate goals are reflected in City operations and long-term strategies.

Human Services and Quality of Life

Kayla Matos, Phoebe Brown, Patrick Kuehl, Margaret Fabrizio

Vision Statement

Promote a healthy, inclusive, and vibrant community where every resident has equitable access to opportunities, services, and spaces that support physical, mental, and social well-being.

Strategic Goals

1. Increase access to culturally competent mental health, addiction, and wellness resources through community-based initiatives, partnerships, and advocacy with Federal, State, and local governments.
2. Expand access to quality-of-life infrastructure, including parks, public spaces, and libraries, particularly for underserved neighborhoods, working families, retirees, and youth.
3. Strengthen neighborhood resilience and social connection through community-building, participatory programs, and investment in civic infrastructure.

Intergovernmental Relations

Pierre Saint-Perez, Margaret Fabrizio, Clyde Lederman

Vision Statement

Strengthen the City's relationships with County, regional, state, and federal partners to improve service delivery, secure external funding, and advance shared priorities for the greater Ithaca community.

Strategic Goals

1. Deepen alignment, communication, collaboration with elected leaders and administration officials across Tompkins County to support and coordinate service delivery, leverage shared infrastructure, and reduce duplication.
2. Position the City to effectively compete for state and federal funding by prioritizing grant readiness, strategic partnerships, and proactive advocacy.
3. Advance collaboration, shared identity, and operational efficiencies through strategic partnership with the Town of Ithaca, including existing and expanded shared services, coordinated planning, and long-term governance alignment to improve outcomes for all Ithacans.